

INFINITE VARIANCE

IV STUDIO MANUAL

STEP BY STEP, WITH EVERY BUTTON POINTED OUT

EDITION 2 NOVEMBER 2026 · IV STUDIO 0.2.2 AND THE NEWEST BUILD · INFINITEVARIANCE.AI

CONTENTS

01 **WELCOME**
What IV Studio is, what you need, how to read this

02 **GETTING AROUND**
Title bar, sidebar, Dashboard, Learn, tips

03 **FIRST-TIME SETUP**
ComfyUI, models and the Setup check

04 **CREATE A SHOT**
Modes, references, the writer, the board, the checker

05 **SHOTS: PICK AND FINISH**
Hunting, best take, Compare, Review, Finish, Enhance

06 **PICTURES**
Create → Image: generate and edit

07 **PROJECTS: A SHORT FILM**
The six-step wizard from idea to film

08 **EDIT**
The editor, new footage, Cut out, Reframe, export

09 **WORKFLOWS**
Sequences, Sizzle, Reel, Shinobi, Replace

10 **CHARACTERS**
Ready-made cast and training your own

11 **LORAS**
Discover on Civitai, your own, the tray

12 **AUDIO**
Voices, Lines and Music

13 **LIBRARY**
Everything you've made, and the viewer

14 **CLOUD**
Render on your own Modal account

15 **SETTINGS**
Every setting, plus Incognito and updates

16 **AGENTS**
Let Claude Code or Codex drive IV Studio

A **KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS**
Editor and app keys

B **TROUBLESHOOTING**
When something doesn't work

C **GLOSSARY**
The words this manual uses



IV Studio is a free, open-source desktop app for making video, pictures, voices and music with AI models that run on your own PC. You say what you want in plain words; IV Studio builds the workflow, renders it in ComfyUI and keeps everything organised.

HOW TO READ THIS MANUAL

Every task has a picture of the real app with **red numbered markers** on the buttons and fields you use. The numbered steps under the picture match the markers: step **3** is the control with marker **3**.

1. Find the marker in the picture.
2. Read the step with the same number.
3. Do it in the app. Labels in **bold** are written exactly as they appear on screen.

WHAT YOU NEED

ITEM	DETAILS
Windows PC	Install `IV-Studio-Setup.exe` from infinitevariance.ai/downloads. IV Studio updates itself after that.
NVIDIA graphics card	To render on your own PC. A 24 GB card runs everything. No suitable card? Use Cloud (chapter 14).
ComfyUI	IV Studio drives your own ComfyUI. Setup (chapter 3) checks it and downloads the models it needs.

> GOOD TO KNOW
> MiniMax H3's licence covers the world except the EU, the UK, South Korea and the USA; use there needs permission from MiniMax. IV Studio itself is MIT-licensed.

> NEWEST BUILD
> Features marked "Newest build" are in the current development build but not yet in the public 0.2.2 release: Learn and the "?" tips, export Loudness, Reel, Cut out, Reframe, and using your own picture as a cast member's face.

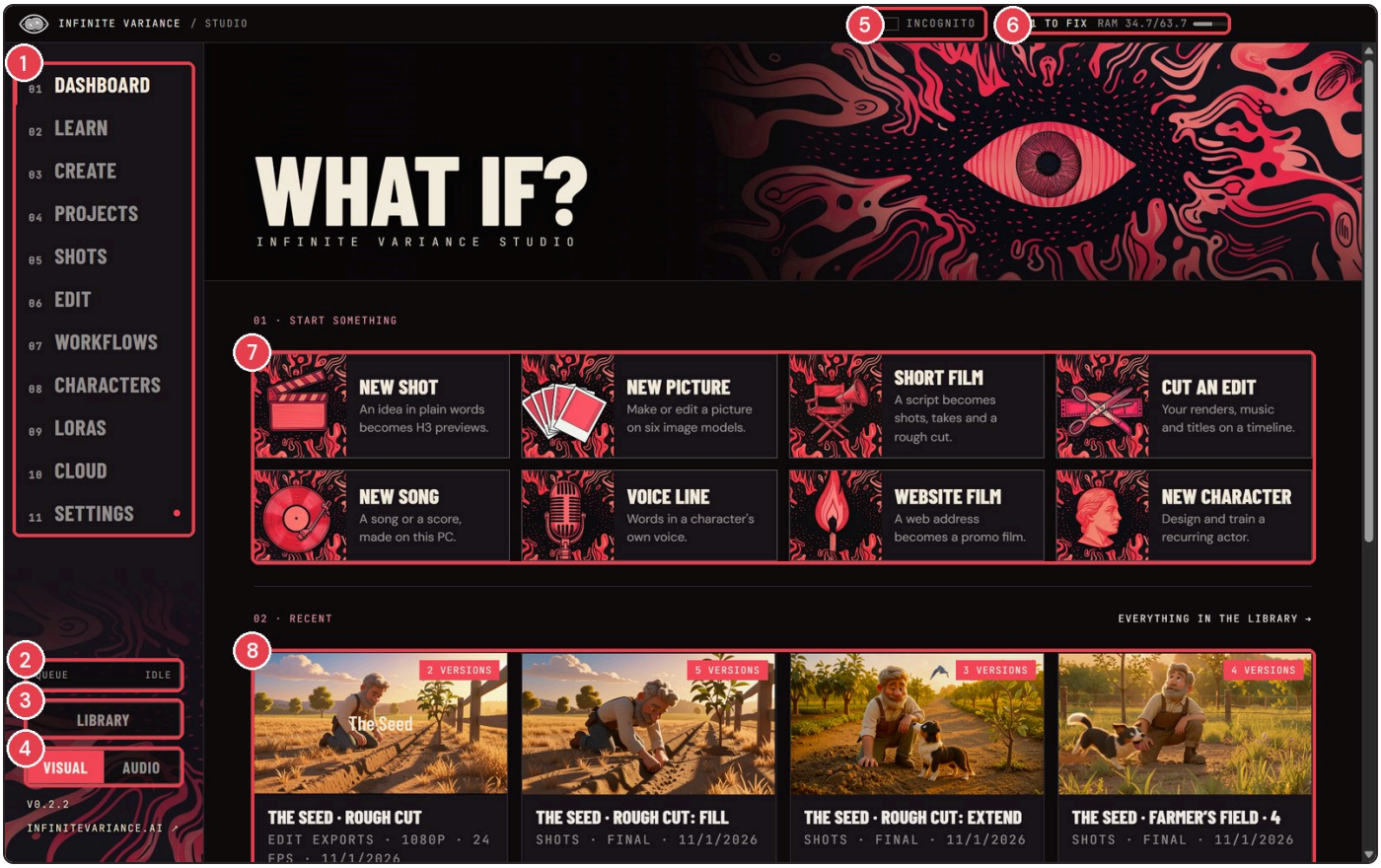
CHAPTER 02



GETTING AROUND

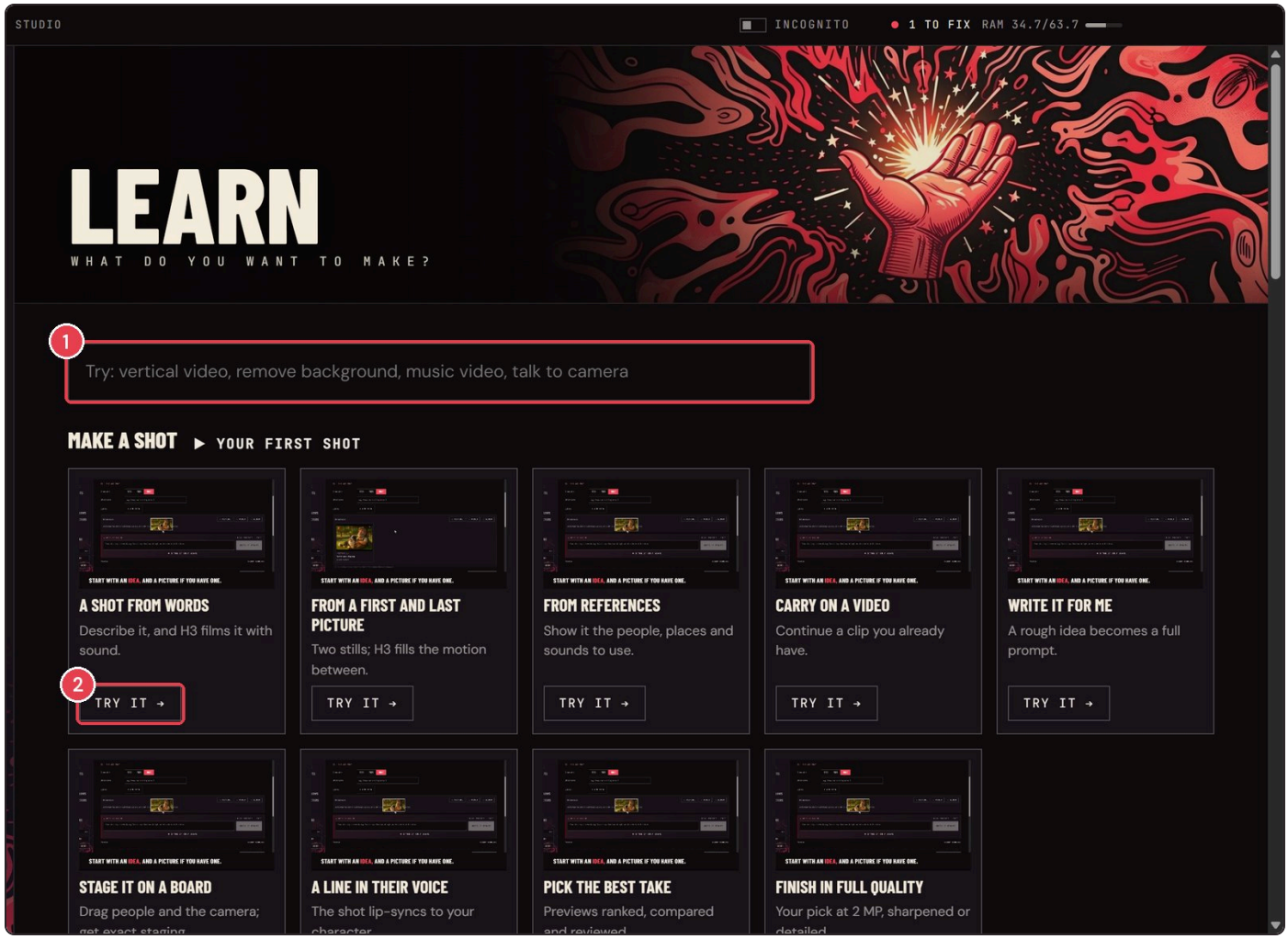
THE WINDOW, THE SIDEBAR AND WHERE TO START

THE MAIN WINDOW



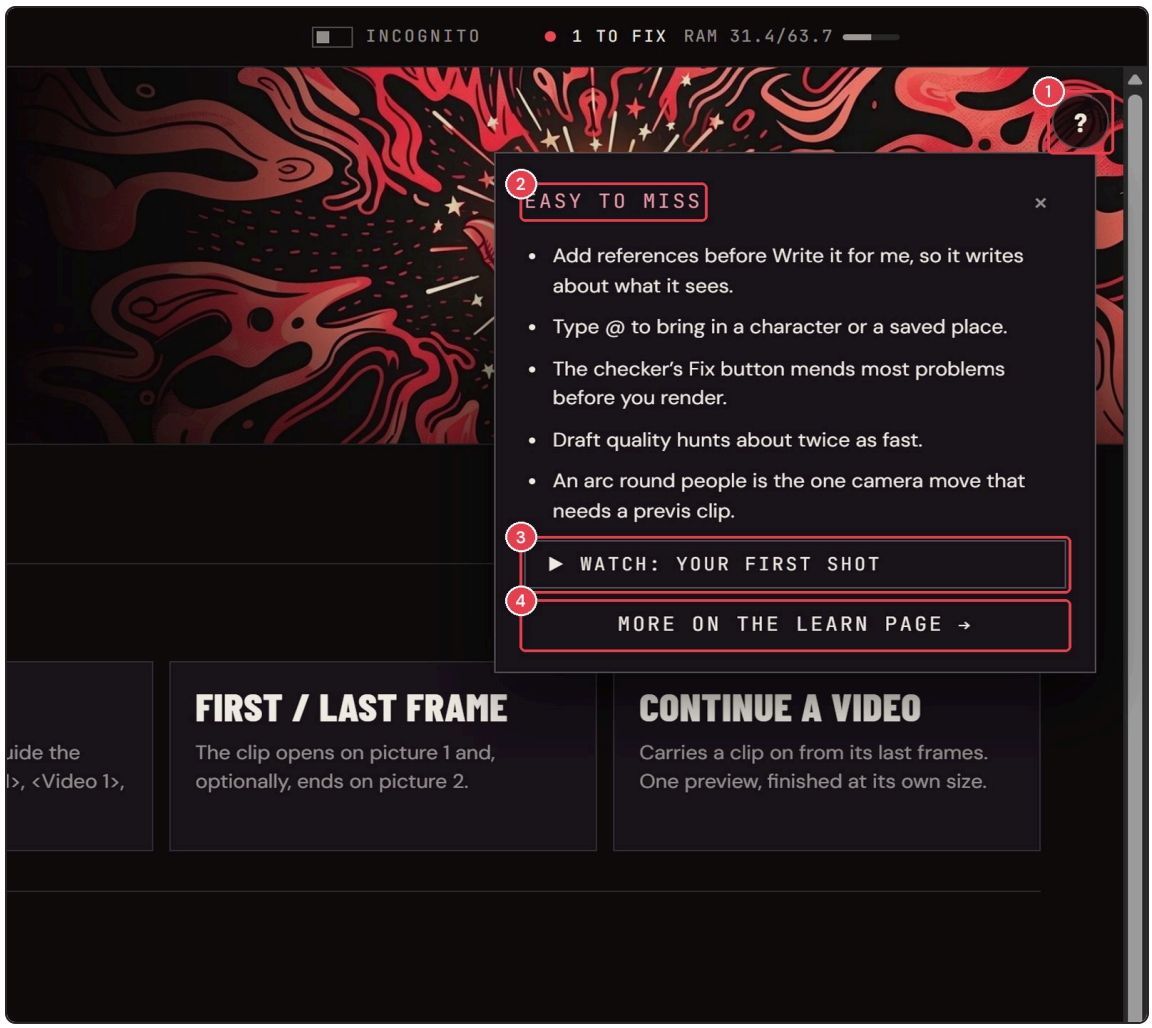
1. **The pages.** Click one to open it: Dashboard, Learn, Create, Projects, Shots, Edit, Workflows, Characters, LoRAs, Cloud and Settings. A red dot on Settings means Setup has something to fix.
2. **Queue.** Shows what is rendering and waiting. Click an item to open its page.
3. **Library.** Everything you have ever made (chapter 13).
4. **Visual | Audio.** Switches the sidebar to the sound pages: Voices, Lines and Music (chapter 12).
5. **Incognito.** Turns on a separate private space (chapter 15).
6. **Status and memory.** "ComfyUI ready", or a red dot with how many things there are **to fix** (click it to go to Setup), plus how much GPU and RAM is in use.
7. **Start something.** Eight quick starts: New shot, New picture, Short film, Cut an edit, New song, Voice line, Website film, New character.
8. **Recent.** Your latest renders. A badge shows how many versions a shot has. Click one to watch it.

HOW TO FIND A TOOL ON THE LEARN PAGE



1. Type what you want in everyday words, for example "vertical video", "remove background" or "music video". Only the matching cards stay.
2. Press **Try it** on a card. IV Studio opens the right page in the right mode.

HOW TO SEE A PAGE'S TIPS



1. Press the **?** in the page's banner.
2. Read the easy-to-miss tips for that page.
3. Press **Watch** to play the page's tutorial video.
4. **More on the Learn page** takes you to its cards.

> NEWEST BUILD
> Learn and the "?" tips are in the newest build.

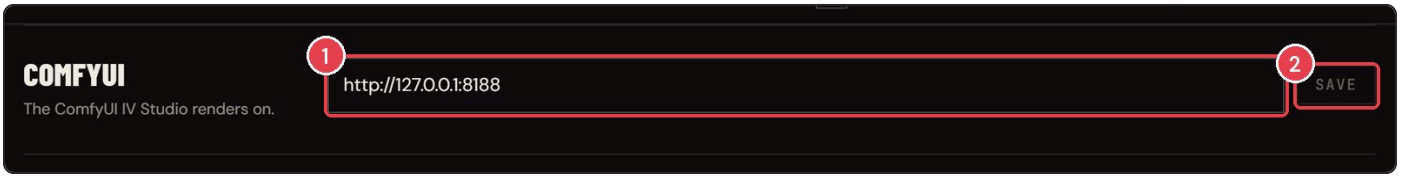
CHAPTER 03

FIRST-TIME SETUP

COMFYUI, MODELS AND THE SETUP CHECK

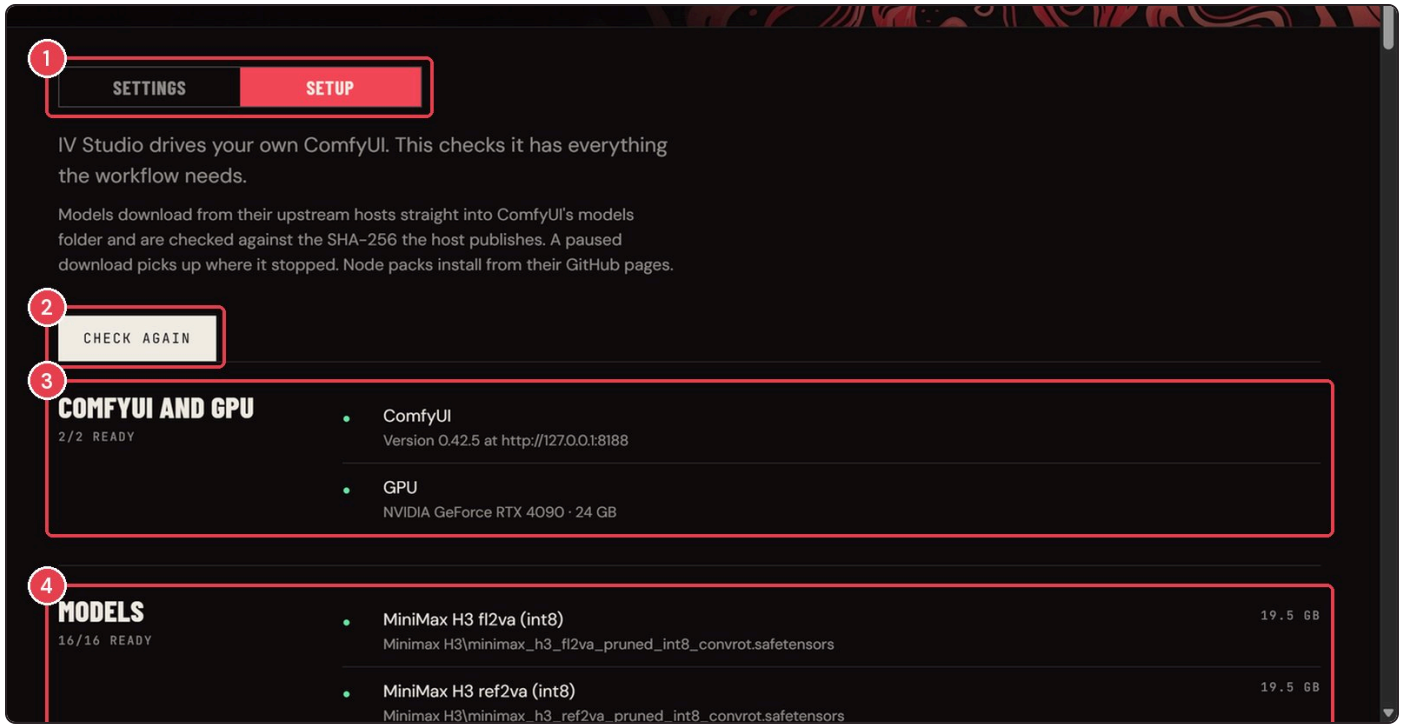
Start ComfyUI the way you normally do and leave it running. Then connect IV Studio to it and let Setup fetch anything missing.

HOW TO CONNECT TO COMFYUI



1. Open **Settings**. Under **ComfyUI**, check the address. It is normally `http://127.0.0.1:8188`.
2. Press **Save**.

HOW TO CHECK EVERYTHING AND DOWNLOAD MODELS



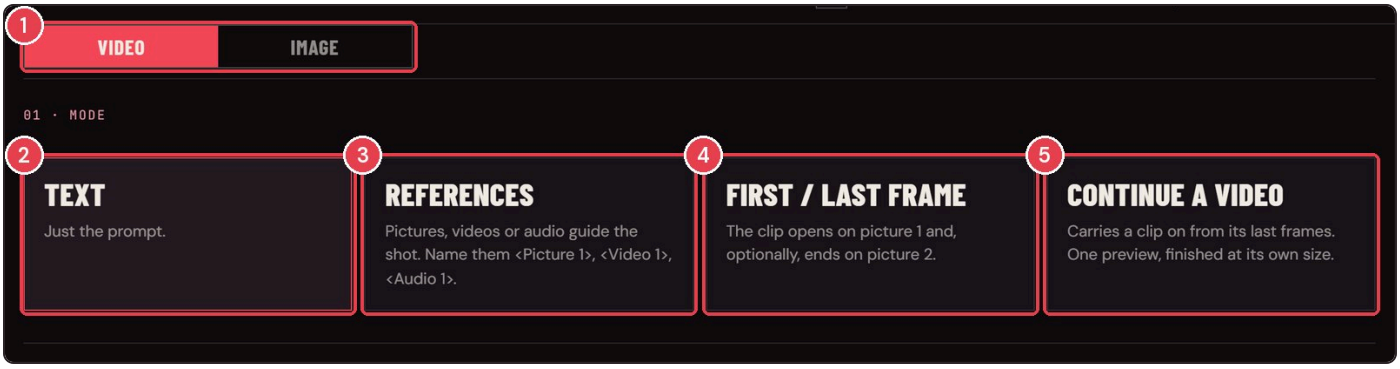
1. At the top of Settings, open the **Setup** tab.
2. Press **Check again** any time you change something.
3. **ComfyUI and GPU:** both need a green dot. If ComfyUI isn't found, check it is running and the address is right.
4. **Models:** every model each workflow needs, with its size. Press **Download** next to anything missing. Downloads go straight into ComfyUI's models folder, resume if interrupted, and are checked against the publisher's SHA-256.

> GOOD TO KNOW
> Some node packs can't be installed from inside IV Studio yet. Setup names them and links to them: install them with ComfyUI-Manager, restart ComfyUI, then press **Check again**.



A shot is a short video clip with sound, made by MiniMax H3. You set it up on the Create page from top to bottom, then hunt a few quick previews and pick the best.

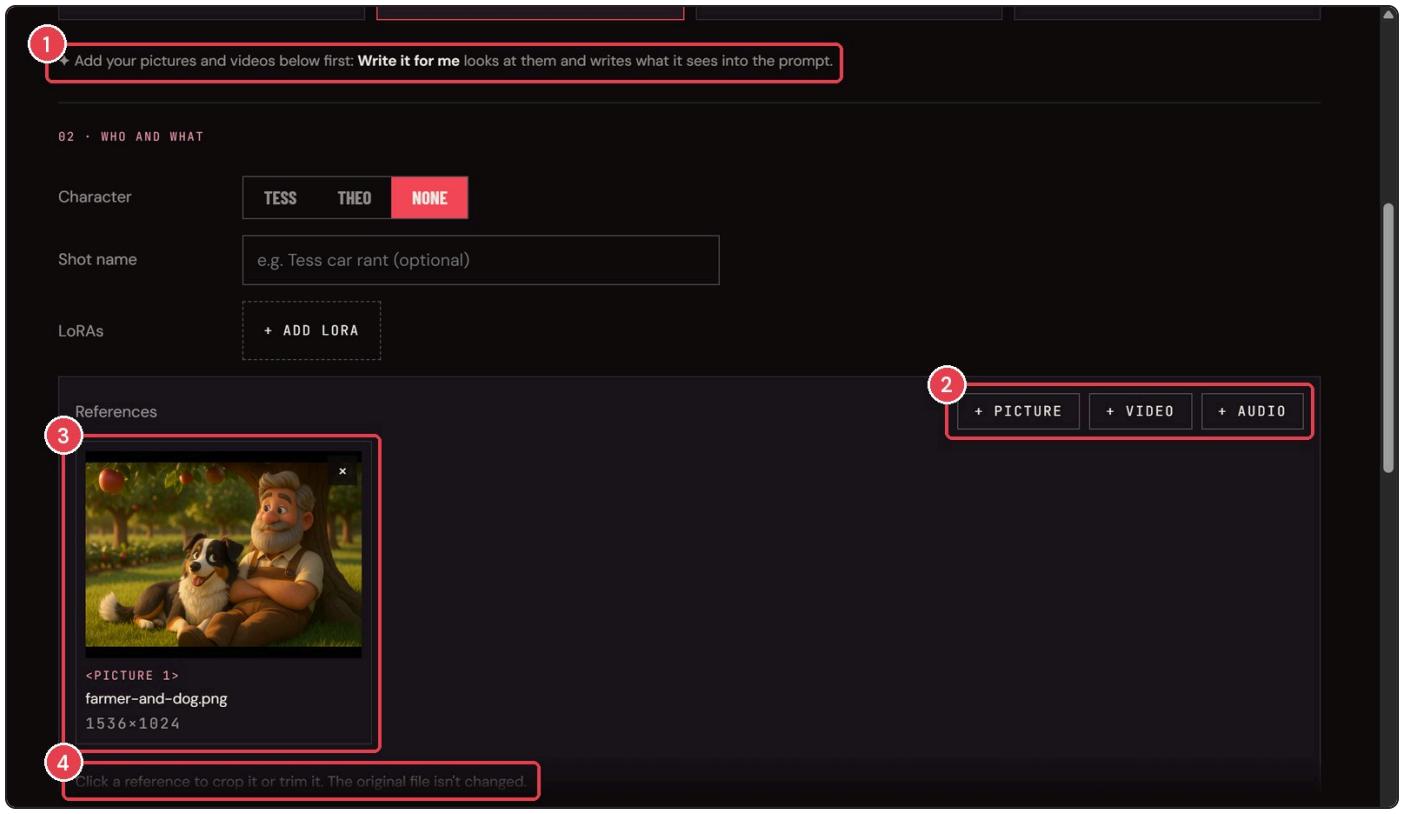
STEP 1 · CHOOSE HOW THE SHOT STARTS



1. Make sure **Video** is selected. (**Image** is for pictures, chapter 6.)
2. **Text:** you only have words. H3 invents everything.
3. **References:** you have pictures, videos or sounds of what should appear (a face, a place, a voice).
4. **First / last frame:** you have the exact opening picture, and optionally the closing one.
5. **Continue a video:** you want to carry on a clip you already have.

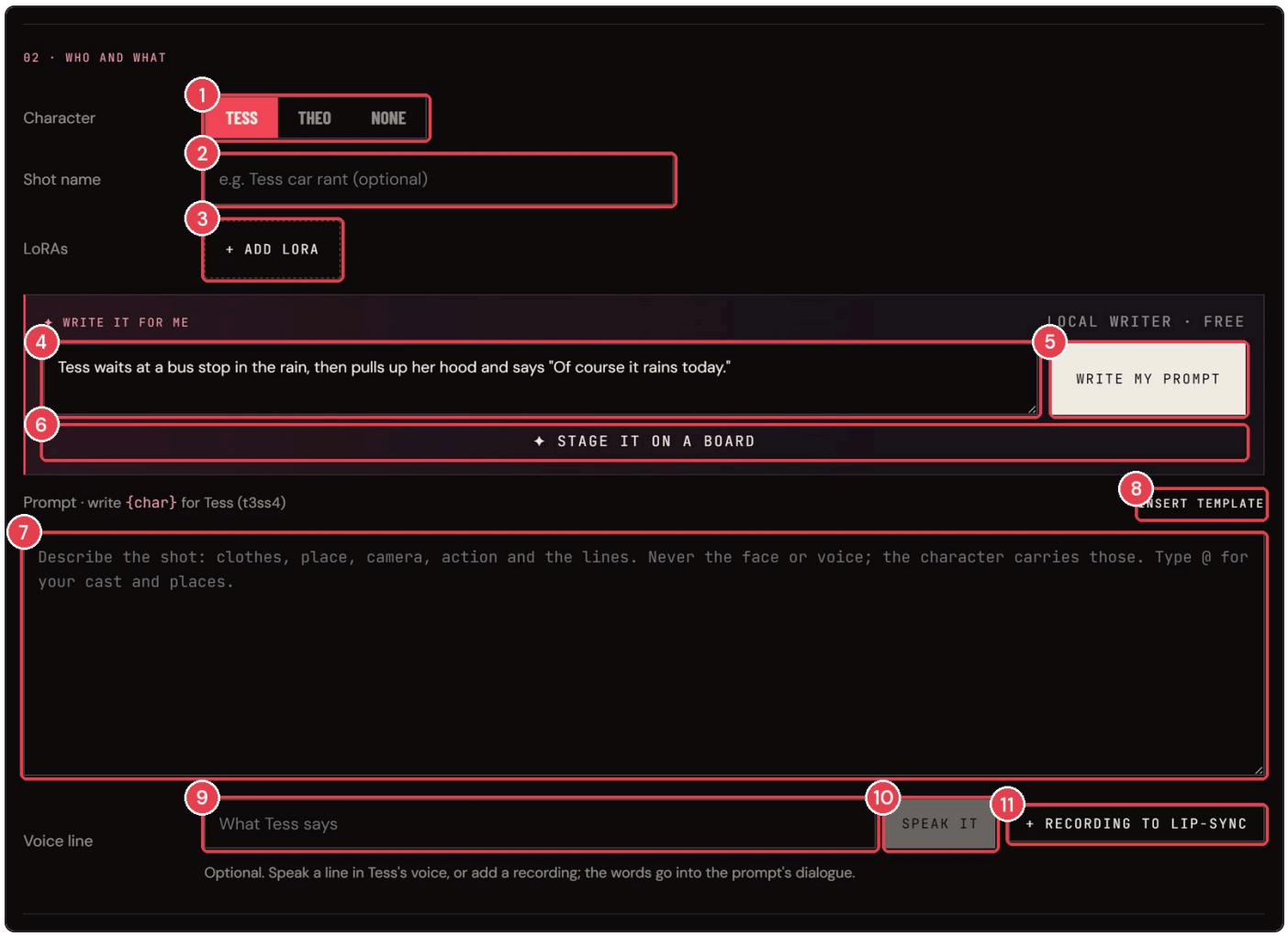
HOW TO ADD REFERENCES

In References, First / last frame and Continue, a box appears for your files.



1. Add your references **before** writing the prompt: Write it for me looks at them.
2. Press **+ Picture**, **+ Video** or **+ Audio**, or drag files onto the box.
3. Each file becomes a tile named `<Picture 1>`, `<Video 1>` and so on. Use those names in the prompt.
4. Click a tile to crop it, trim it, or **Fit for H3** (resize to H3's sizes). Your original file is never changed.

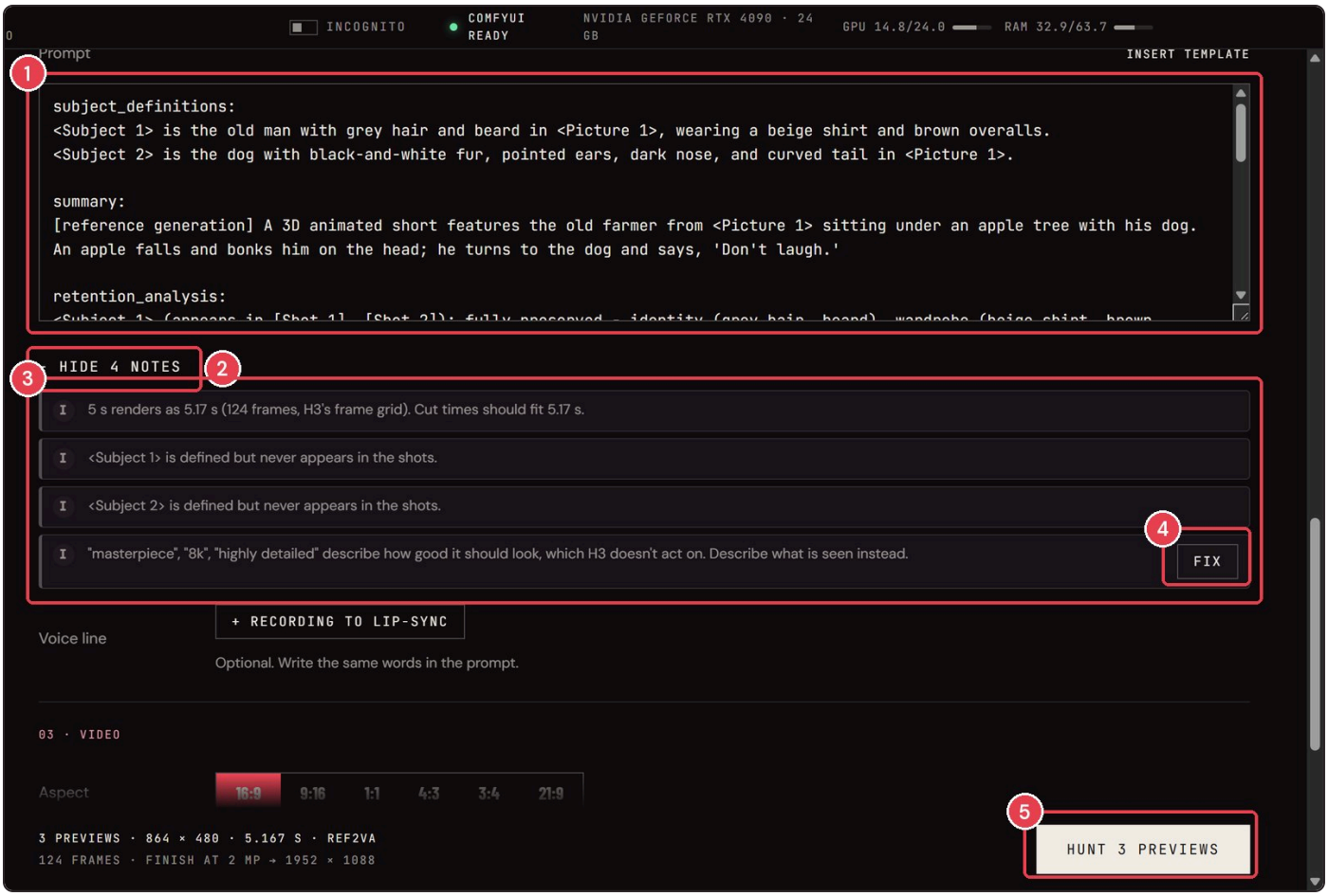
STEP 2 · WHO IS IN IT AND WHAT HAPPENS



1. **Character:** pick Tess, Theo, one of your own, or **None**. A character keeps the same face; don't describe their face in the prompt.
2. **Shot name:** optional. Without one, the shot is named from its first words.
3. **+ Add LoRA:** adds a style or look from your LoRAs, with a strength slider (chapter 11).
4. **Write it for me:** type your idea in plain words. Put a spoken line in quotes to keep those exact words.
5. Press **Write my prompt**. The full H3 prompt fills box 7. The writer is set in Settings → Prompt writer.
6. **✦ Stage it on a board:** opens the floor plan for who stands where (below).
7. **Prompt:** the H3 prompt. Edit it freely. Write `{char}` where the character goes, and type `@` to bring in a character or a saved place.
8. **Insert template:** drops in the H3 prompt layout if you want to write it yourself.
9. **Voice line:** what the character says, for lip-sync.
10. **Speak it:** says the line in the character's voice and uses it for lip-sync.
11. **+ Recording to lip-sync:** use your own recording of the line instead.

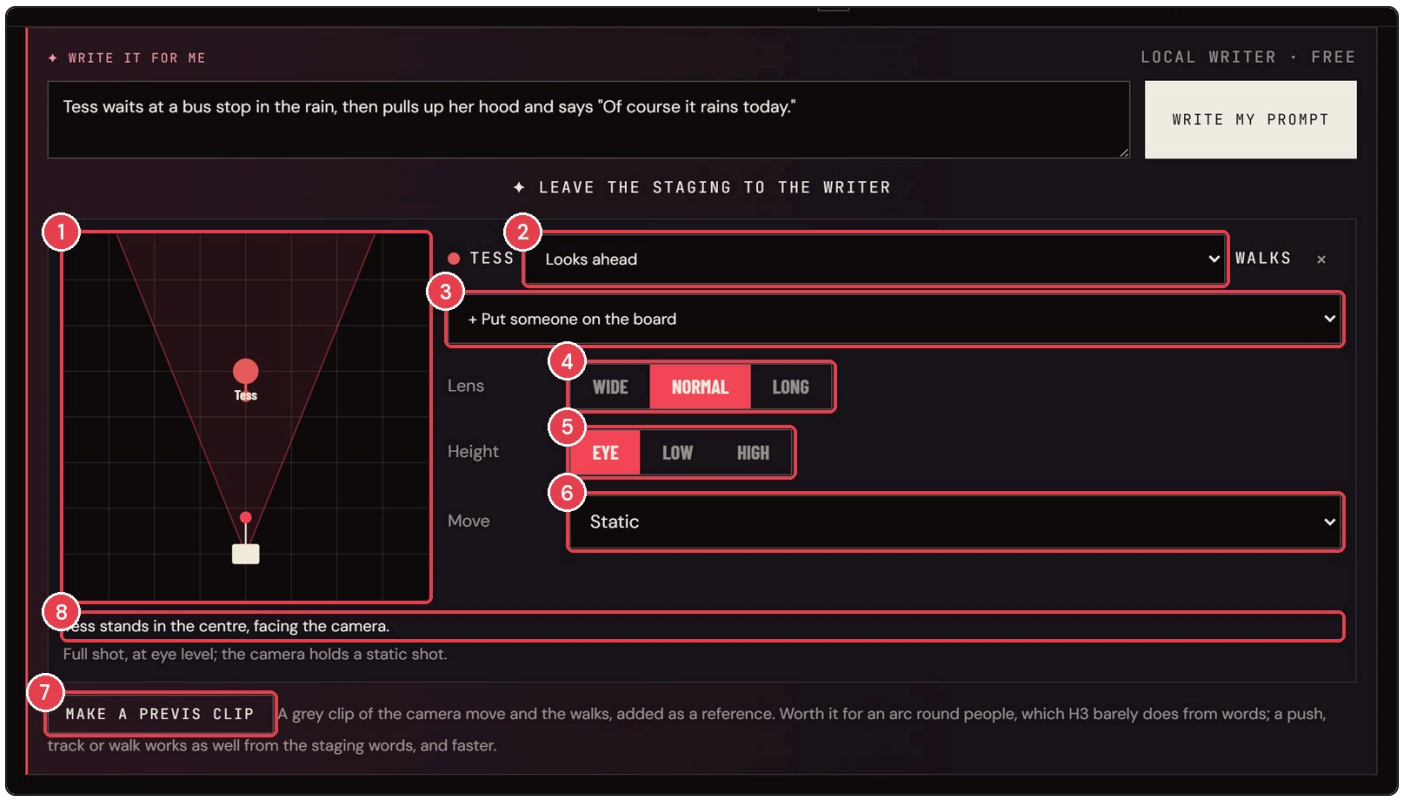
HOW TO FIX PROBLEMS THE CHECKER FINDS

Before you hunt, IV Studio checks the prompt for things that waste render time.



1. The prompt that will be rendered.
2. **Hide / show notes** folds the list away.
3. Each note says what's wrong in plain words.
4. Press **Fix** to let IV Studio mend it. Notes without Fix need you to change the prompt.
5. Errors hold the **Hunt** button until fixed. **Render anyway** appears if you want to go ahead.

HOW TO STAGE PEOPLE AND THE CAMERA



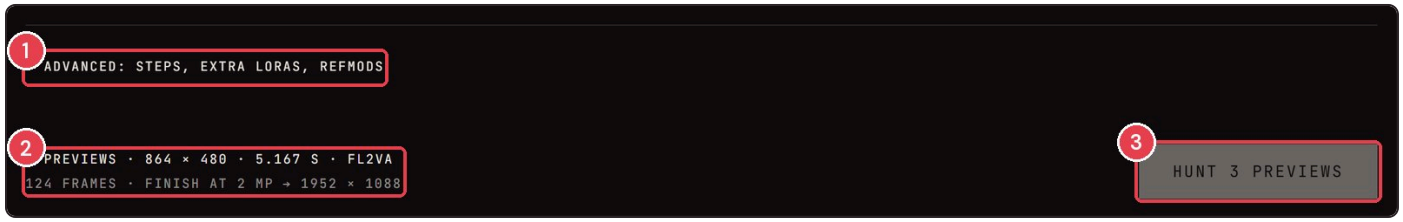
1. **The floor plan,** seen from above. Drag people and the camera (the white square at the bottom). The red cone is what the camera sees.
2. Where the person looks: ahead, at the camera, or at someone else. **Walks** draws a path for them.
3. **+ Put someone on the board:** adds another person (up to four).
4. **Lens:** wide, normal or long.
5. **Height:** eye level, low or high.
6. **Move:** static, push, pull, pan, arc, track, handheld and more.
7. **Make a previs clip:** renders the board as a grey moving guide and adds it as a reference. Worth it for an **arc** round people; other moves work as well from the words alone.
8. The exact words IV Studio writes from the board: who is screen-left or right, how big in frame, how the camera moves.

STEP 3 · VIDEO SETTINGS



1. **Aspect:** 16:9 wide, 9:16 vertical, 1:1 square, 4:3, 3:4 or 21:9.
2. **Length** in seconds. H3 renders on a fixed frame grid, so 5 s becomes 5.17 s.
3. **Preview size:** 0.3 to 0.8 MP. Small previews are quick; you choose the final size later.
4. **Previews:** how many takes to try (1 to 3), each on its own seed.
5. **Quality: Draft** (about 40% quicker, a touch softer, good for hunting) or **Standard**.
6. **Seed:** the starting number. 🎲 **New seed** picks another.

STEP 4 · HUNT



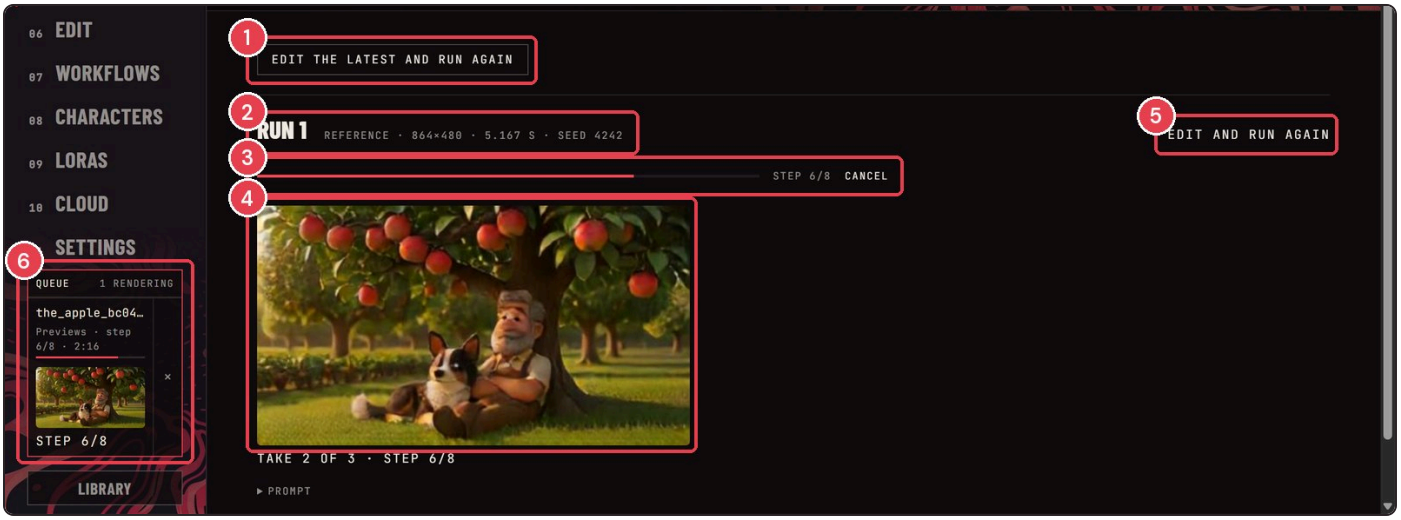
1. **+ Advanced** (optional): the step count and RefMods, saved references for a look, voice, place or style.
2. The summary: how many previews, their size, the real length and the mode.
3. Press **Hunt 3 previews**. The shot's page opens and the takes render there (chapter 5).

CHAPTER 05

SHOTS

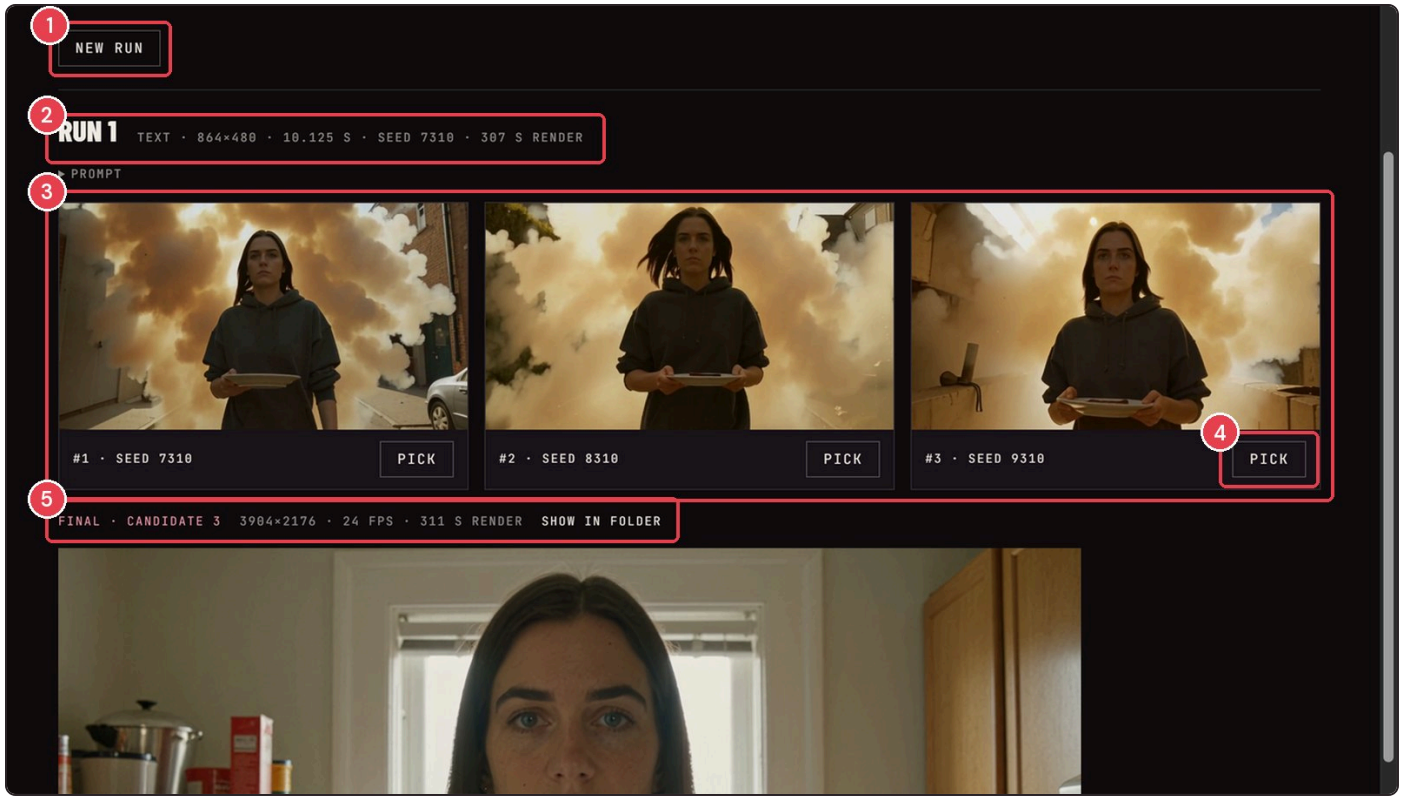
PICK THE BEST TAKE AND FINISH IT

HOW TO WATCH TAKES RENDER



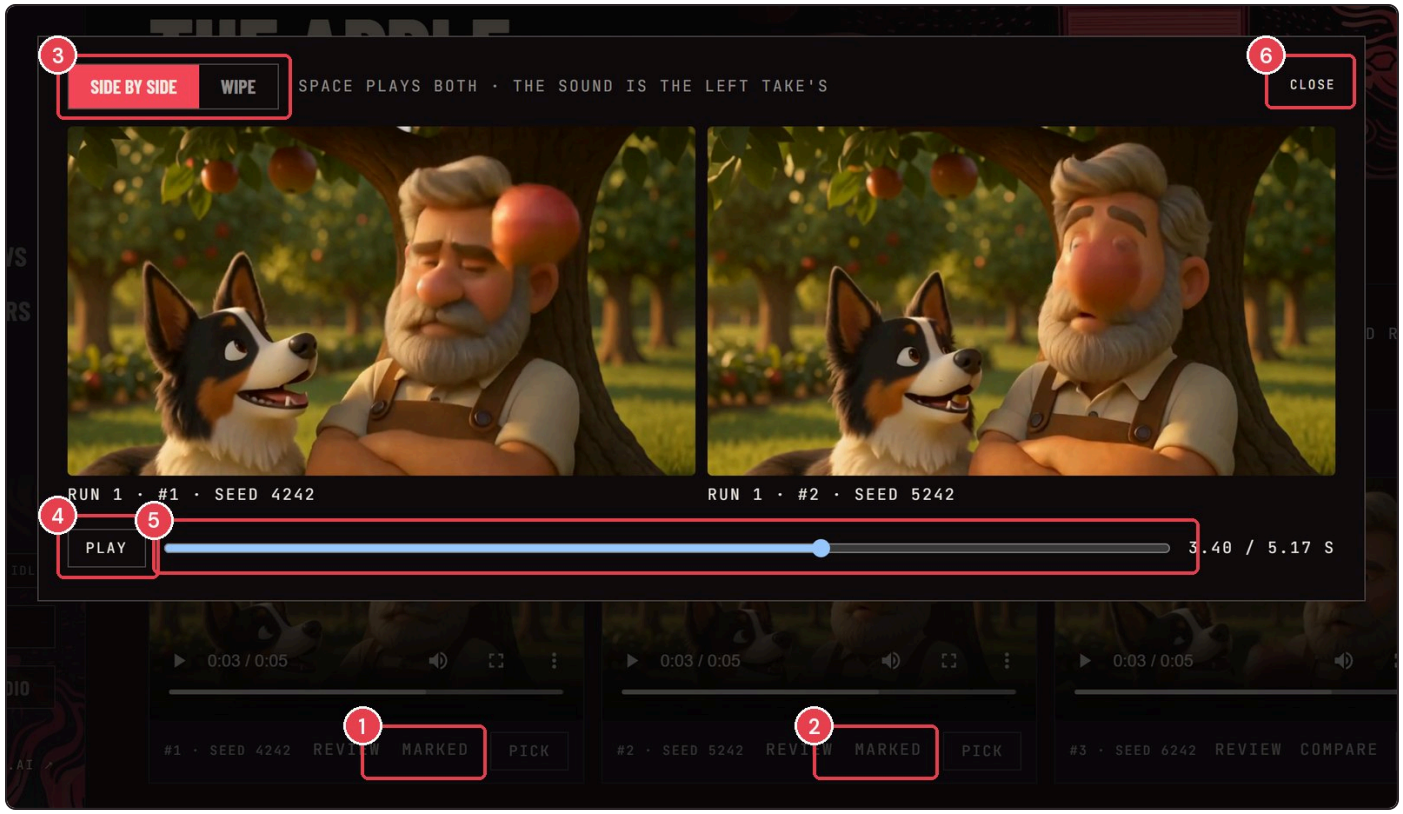
1. **Edit the latest and run again:** opens this shot's prompt and files in Create, to try a new version.
2. The run: its mode, size, length and seed.
3. Progress. **Cancel** stops the run.
4. Each take shows a live picture at every step, then plays when it's done.
5. **Edit and run again** for this particular run.
6. The sidebar Queue shows the same progress from any page.

HOW TO CHOOSE A TAKE



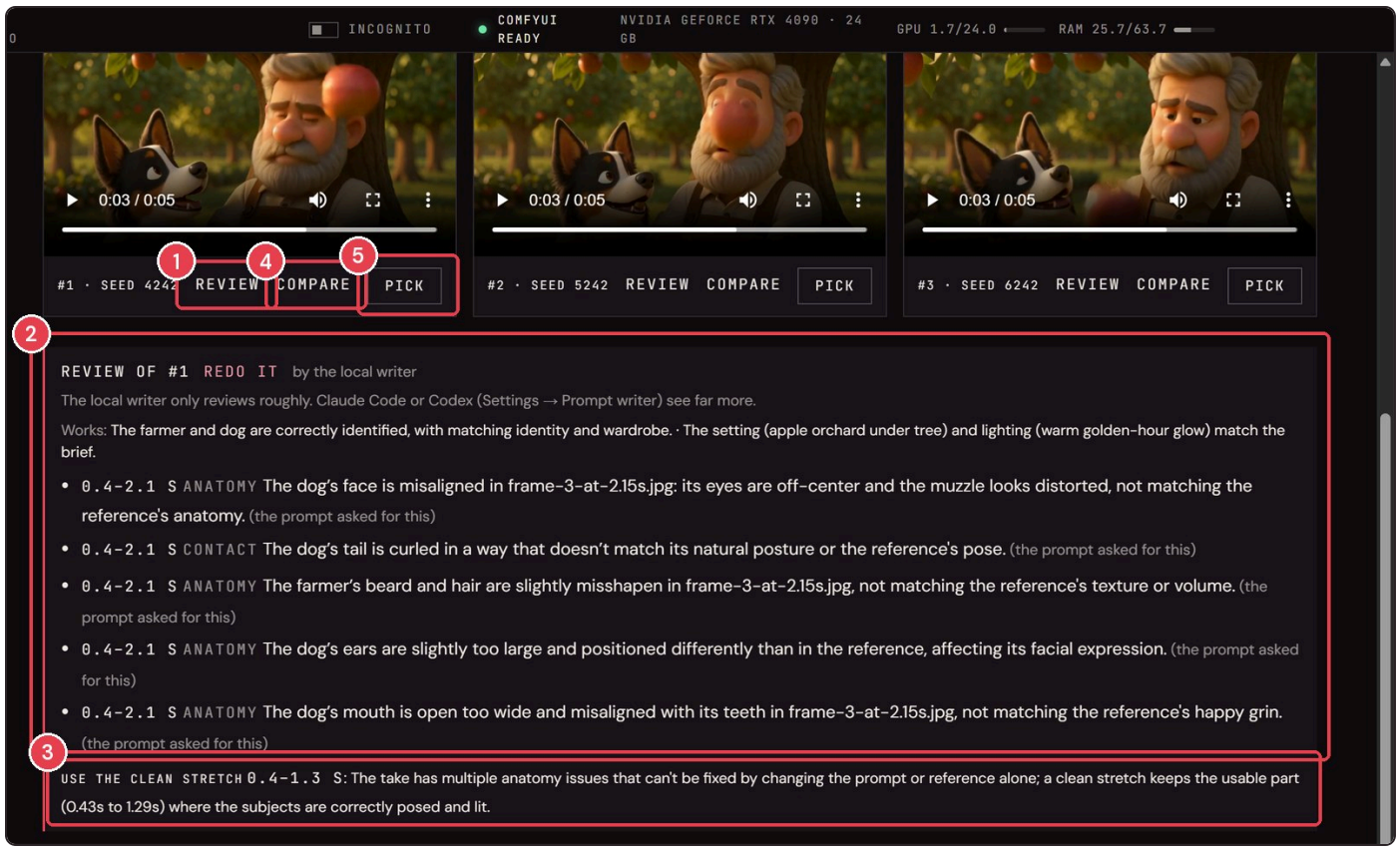
1. **New run:** another set of takes in the same shot. Every run is kept as a version.
2. The run's settings. **Prompt** under it shows the prompt as written and as rendered.
3. The takes, each with its seed. A ★ marks the best when one clearly leads (words heard, likeness, no frozen frames, sharpness).
4. Press **Pick** on the one you want. The Finish panel opens.
5. The finished version appears under the run.

HOW TO COMPARE TWO TAKES



1. Press **Compare** on the first take (it changes to **Marked**).
2. Press **Compare** on the second. The viewer opens.
3. **Side by side** or **Wipe** (drag across one picture).
4. **Play** runs both in step. The sound is the left take's.
5. Drag to scrub both at once.
6. **Close** when done.

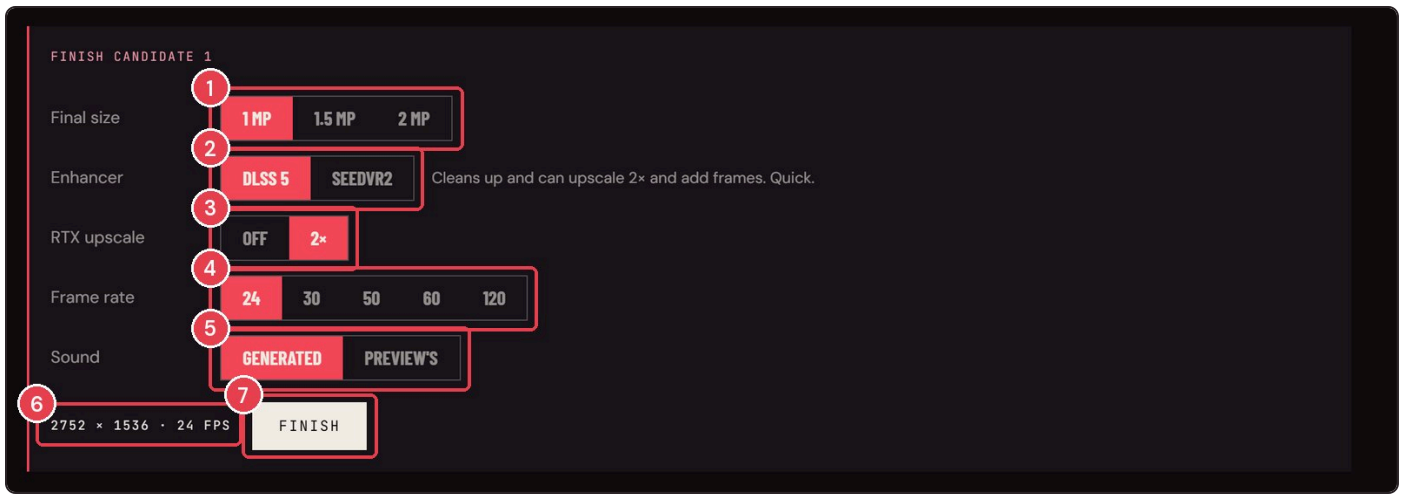
HOW TO GET A REVIEW OF A TAKE



1. Press **Review** under a take.
2. Your prompt writer lists what works and each problem, with the seconds it happens.
3. It recommends one fix: revise the prompt, change a reference, split the action, use a clean stretch, or fix it in the edit. A revised prompt has **Edit and run again with this prompt**.
4. **Compare** and
5. **Pick** sit beside it.

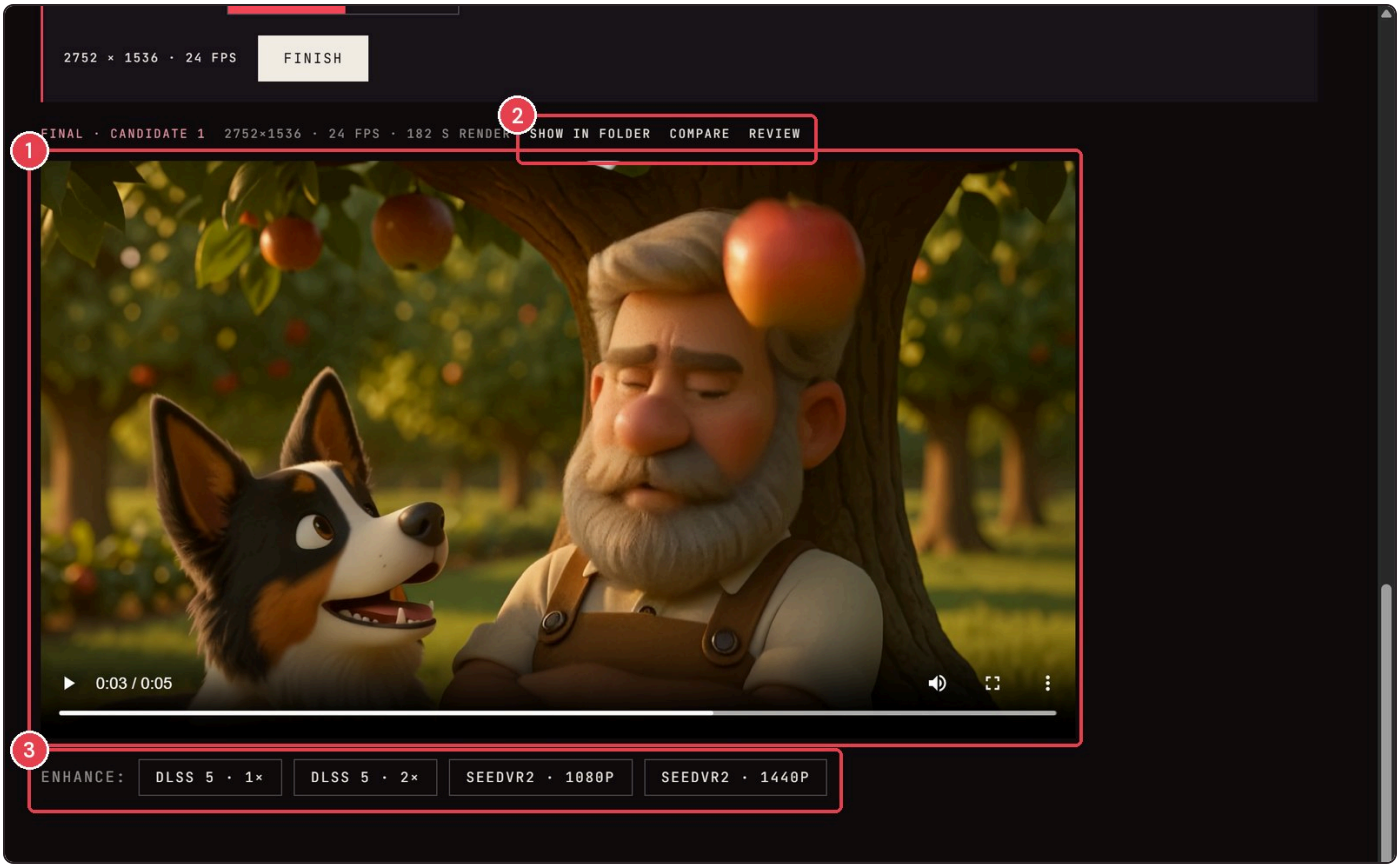
> GOOD TO KNOW
> Claude Code and Codex give the most useful reviews. The free local writer's reviews are labelled rough.

HOW TO FINISH A TAKE IN FULL QUALITY



1. **Final size:** 1, 1.5 or 2 MP. 1 MP keeps the preview's motion most faithfully; 2 MP adds detail but can change small movements.
2. **Enhancer: DLSS 5** (quick clean-up, can upscale and add frames) or **SeedVR2** (slower, restores face, eye and hair detail; pick 1080p, 1440p or 2160p).
3. **RTX upscale:** off or 2×.
4. **Frame rate:** 24 as rendered, or 30, 50, 60 or 120 with frame generation.
5. **Sound: Generated** (H3's own), **Preview's** (keeps a cloned voice), or **My recording** (your voice line exactly).
6. The final size and frame rate you'll get.
7. Press **Finish**.

THE FINISHED TAKE



1. Play the final.
2. **Show in folder** opens the file. **Compare** and **Review** work on finals too.
3. **Enhance:** run DLSS 5 (1× or 2×) or SeedVR2 (1080p or 1440p) again later. Each result is kept as its own version.

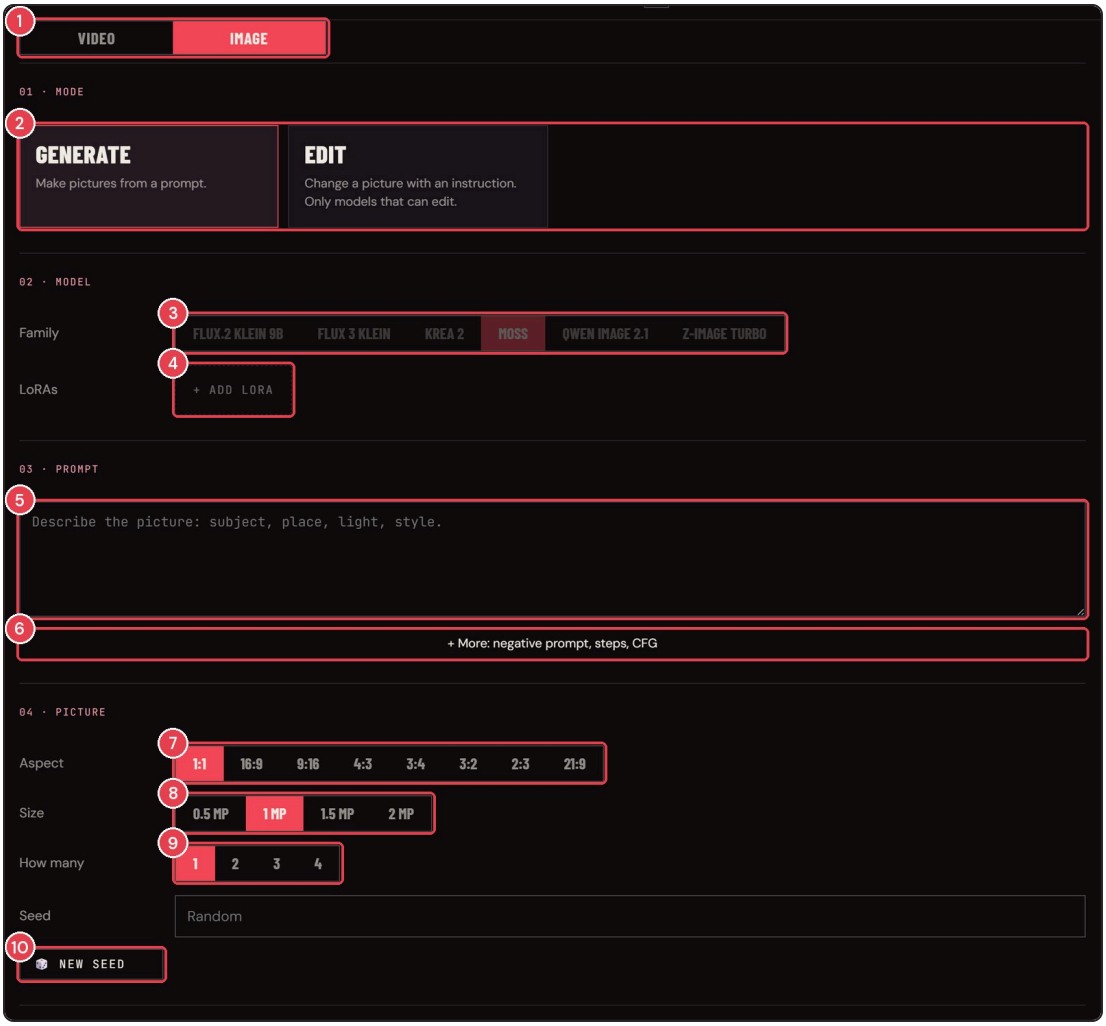
CHAPTER 06

PICTURES

CREATE → IMAGE



HOW TO MAKE OR EDIT A PICTURE



1. At the top of Create, switch to **Image**.
2. **Generate** makes a new picture from words. **Edit** changes a picture you give it.
3. **Family:** Flux.2 Klein 9B, Flux 3 Klein, Krea 2, Moss, Qwen Image 2.1 or Z-Image Turbo. In Edit, only the models that can edit are offered.
4. **+ Add LoRA:** this family's own LoRAs.
5. Describe the picture: subject, place, light, style. In Edit, say what to change and what to keep.
6. **+ More:** a negative prompt, steps and CFG, if you want them.
7. **Aspect.**
8. **Size** from 0.5 to 2 MP.
9. **How many** pictures, 1 to 4.
10. **Seed.** Then press **Make 4 pictures** (or **Edit**) at the bottom.

THE GALLERY

Your pictures appear under **Your pictures**. Click one to open the viewer: **Use in a shot** (opens Create → Video in First / last frame mode with it), **Edit this**, **Add to edit**, **Make more like this** and **Show file**.

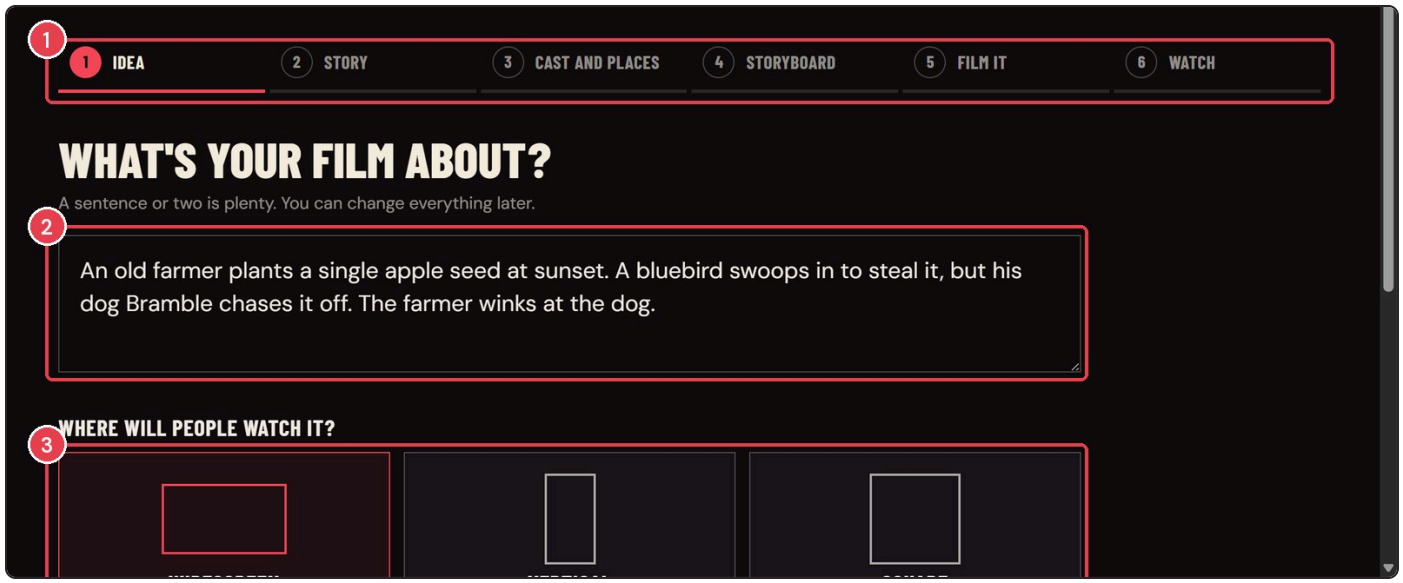
CHAPTER 07

PROJECTS

A SHORT FILM IN SIX STEPS

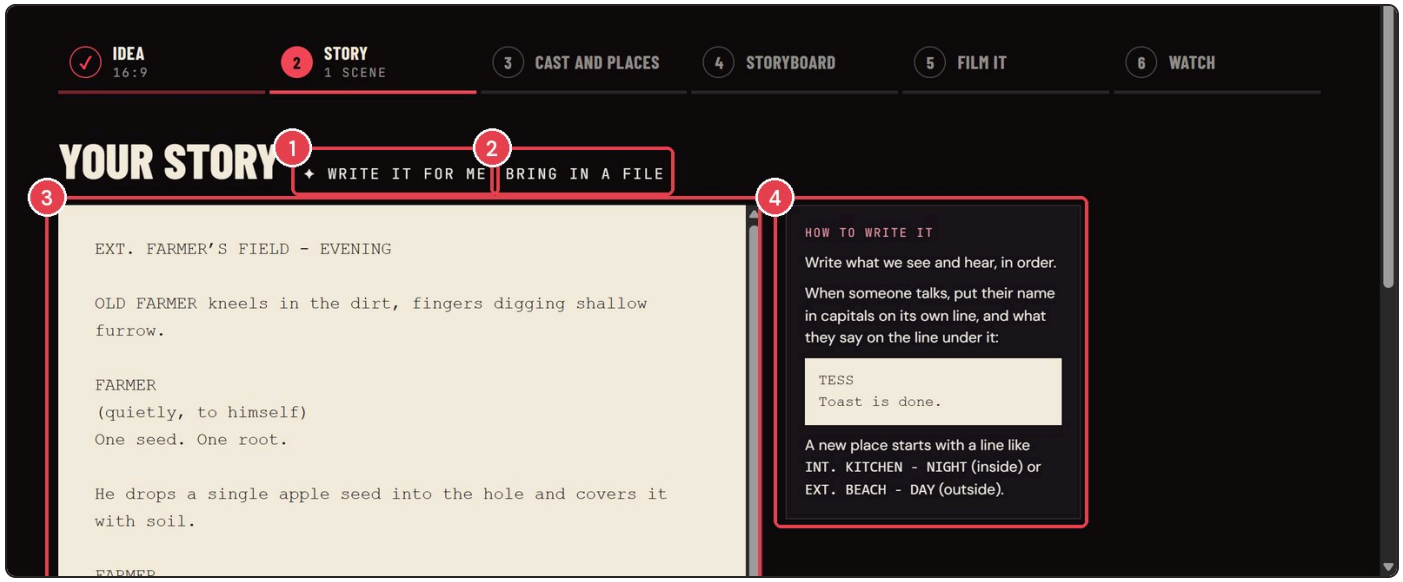
Projects turns an idea or a script into a finished short film. Open **Projects**, press **New film**, and follow the step bar.

1 · IDEA



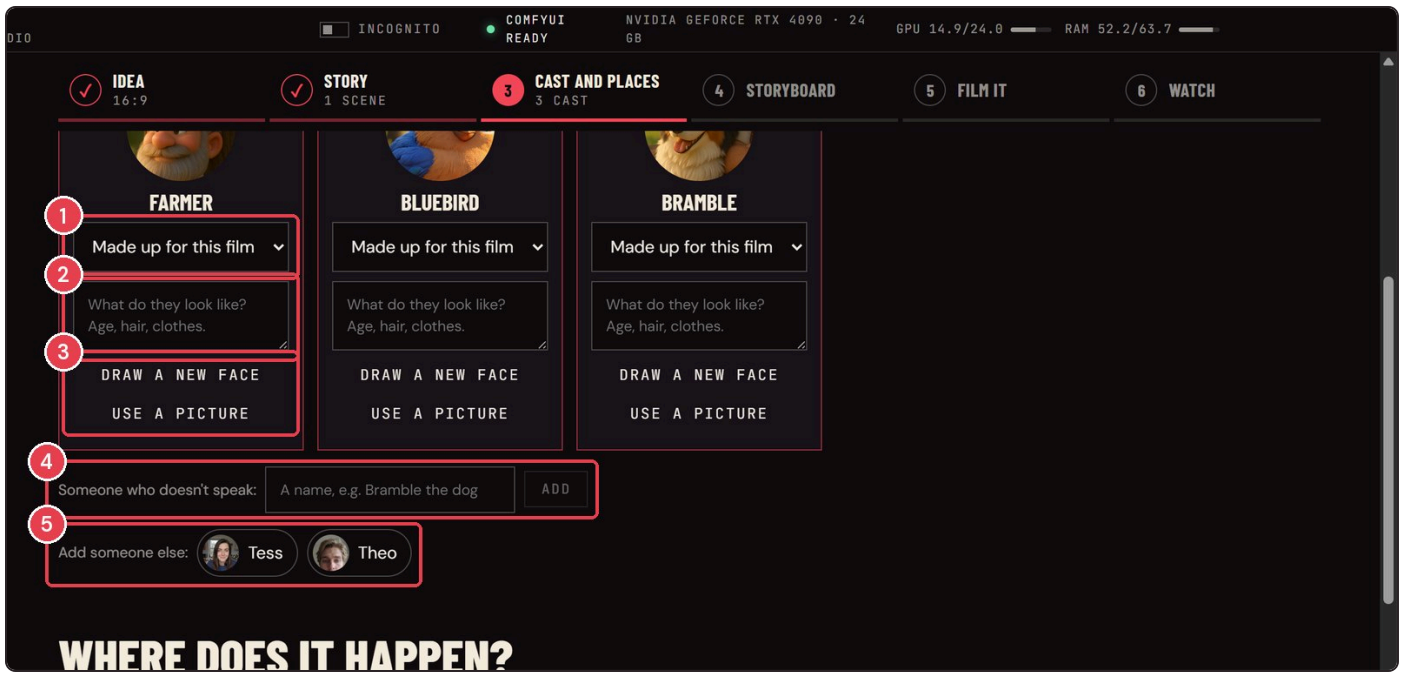
1. The step bar: Idea, Story, Cast and places, Storyboard, Film it, Watch. Click any finished step to go back.
2. Say what the film is about in a sentence or two.
3. Choose where people will watch it: widescreen, vertical or square. Then choose the length further down.

2 · STORY



1. ✦ **Write it for me:** drafts a script from your idea, cast and length.
2. **Bring in a file:** a `.txt` or `.fountain` script.
3. The script. Edit it, or write your own in plain words.
4. **How to write it:** put a speaker's name in capitals with their line under it; start a new place with `INT.` or `EXT.`

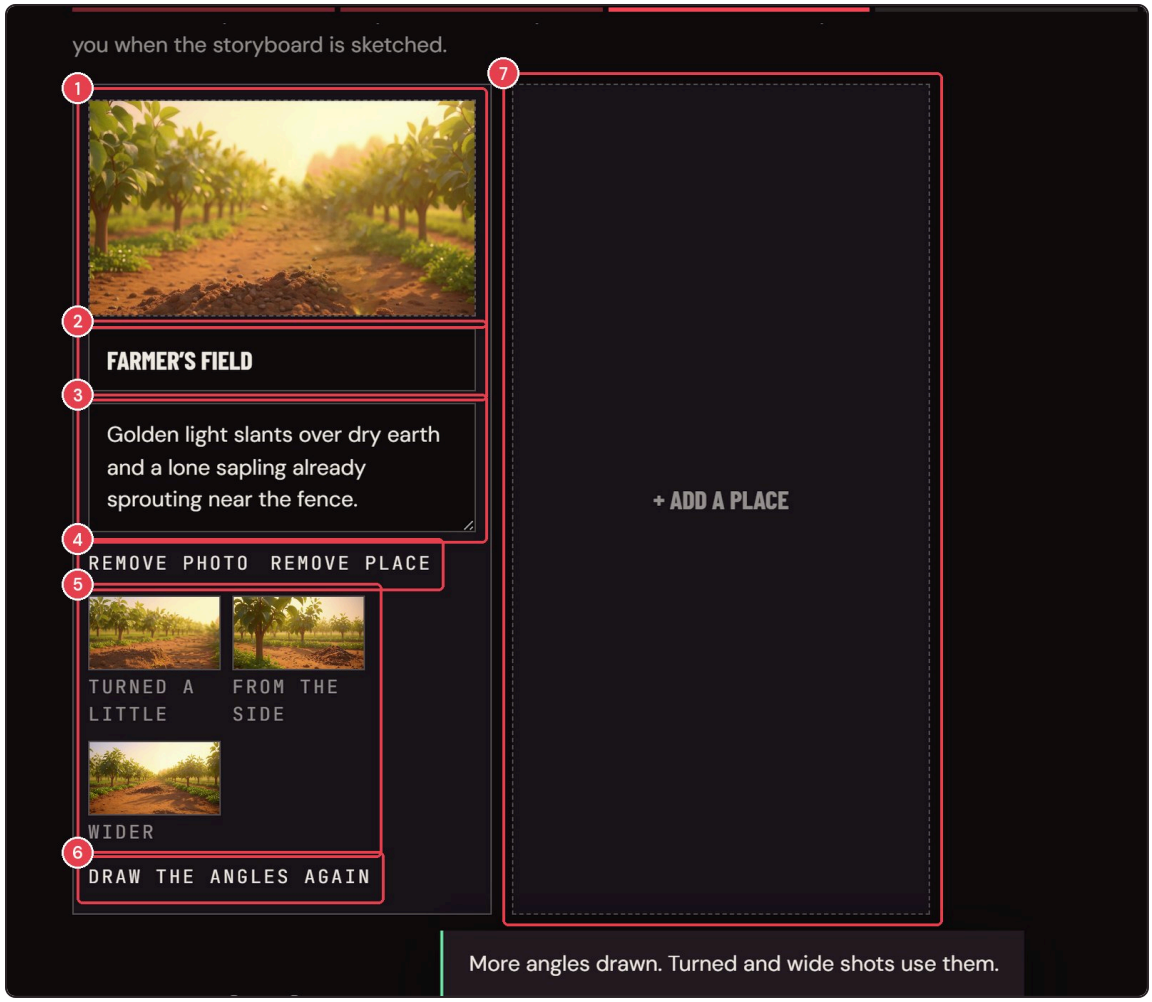
3 · CAST



1. Who plays each part: one of your characters, or **Made up for this film**.
2. For a made-up part, describe them: age, hair, clothes.
3. **Draw a new face** from that description, or **Use a picture** of your own. They keep that face in every shot.
4. **Someone who doesn't speak** (a dog, a bird): type a name and press **Add**.
5. **Add someone else:** bring one of your characters into the film.

> NEWEST BUILD
> **Use a picture** is in the newest build.

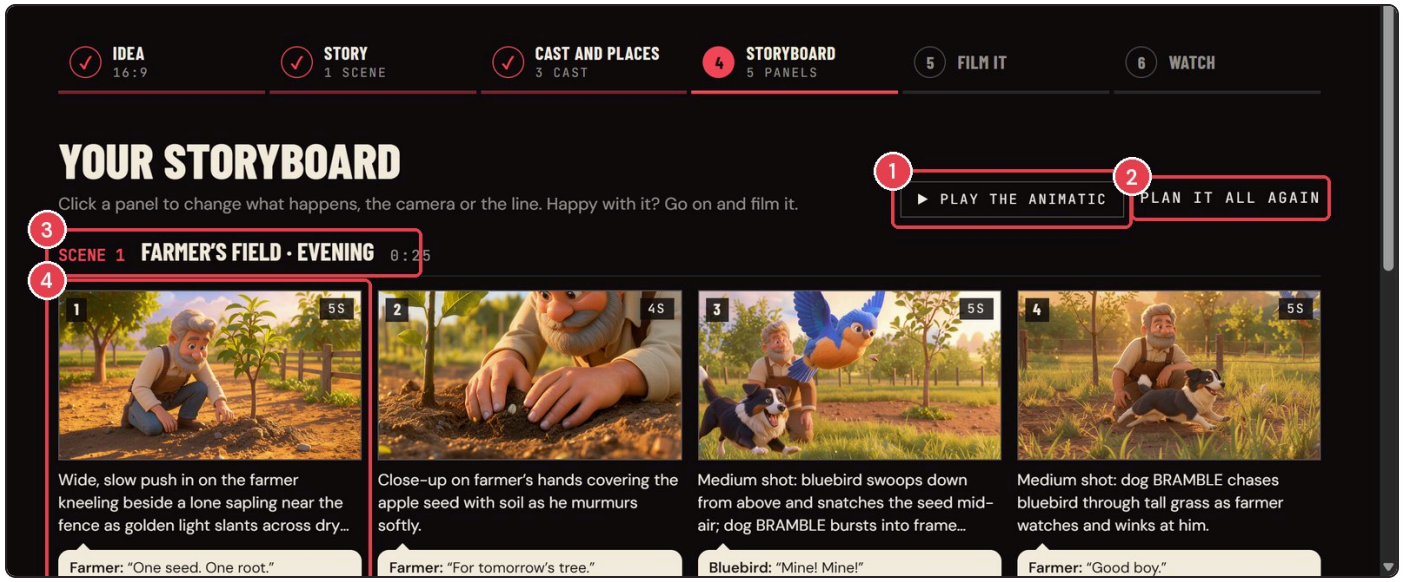
3 · PLACES



1. The place's picture: add a photo, or one is drawn when the storyboard is sketched. Every shot there starts from it, so the set stays the same.
2. The place's name.
3. Describe it.
4. **Remove photo** or **Remove place**.
5. Extra angles: **Turned a little**, **From the side** and **Wider**. Wide and turned shots use them.
6. **+ More angles** draws them (here, **Draw the angles again**).
7. **+ Add a place.**

Below the places, **What should it look like?** sets the style (natural, cinematic, 16 mm and more), your own words and style LoRAs.

4 · STORYBOARD



1. ▶ **Play the animatic:** the sketches play as a film with the spoken lines, to check pacing before filming.
2. **Plan it all again:** replans and redraws every shot.
3. Each scene with its place and planned length.
4. A panel: the sketch, what happens and the spoken line. Click it to change it.

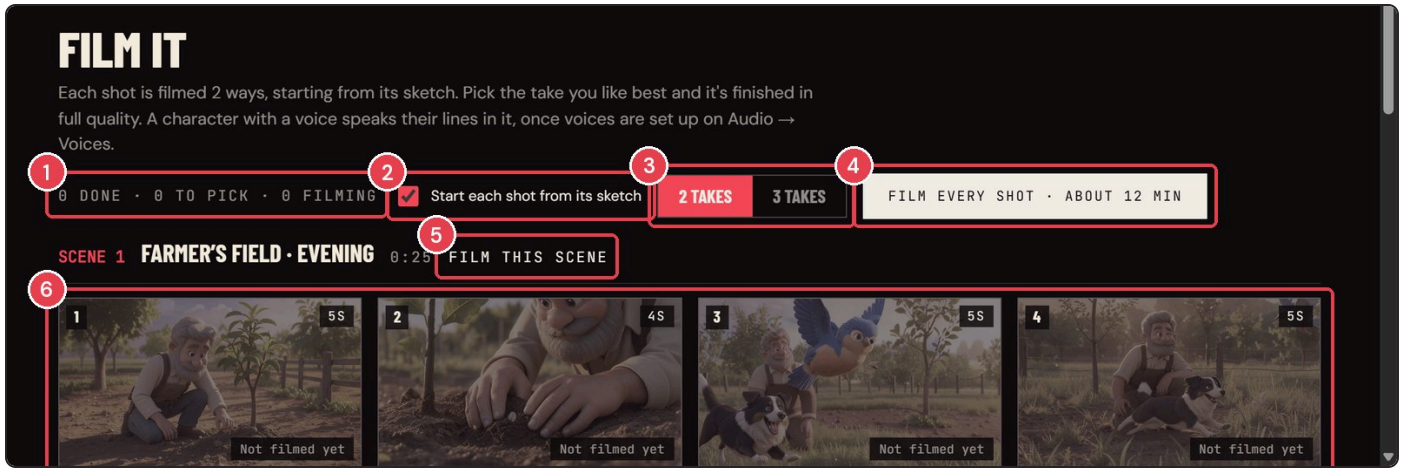
HOW TO CHANGE ONE SHOT



1. The shot's sketch. Redraw it from the buttons further down.
2. **What we see:** the action.
3. **Who stands where:** the staging in words.
4. **Draw it on a board:** the staging board for this shot (chapter 4).
5. **Camera:** the shot size and move.
6. **How it ends:** the next shot starts from here.

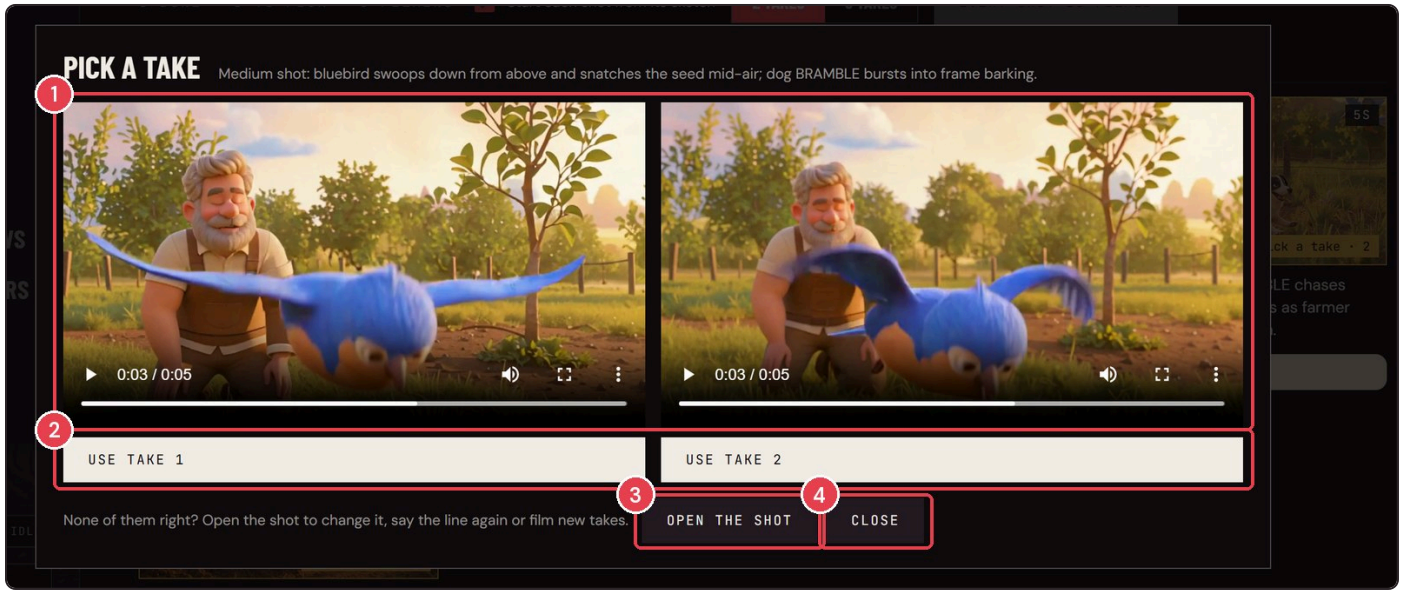
Further down the drawer: the speaker and line, ♪ **Use a recording of the line**, the length, **Carry straight on from shot N** (a one-take shot with no cut), and redraw, move or remove.

5 · FILM IT



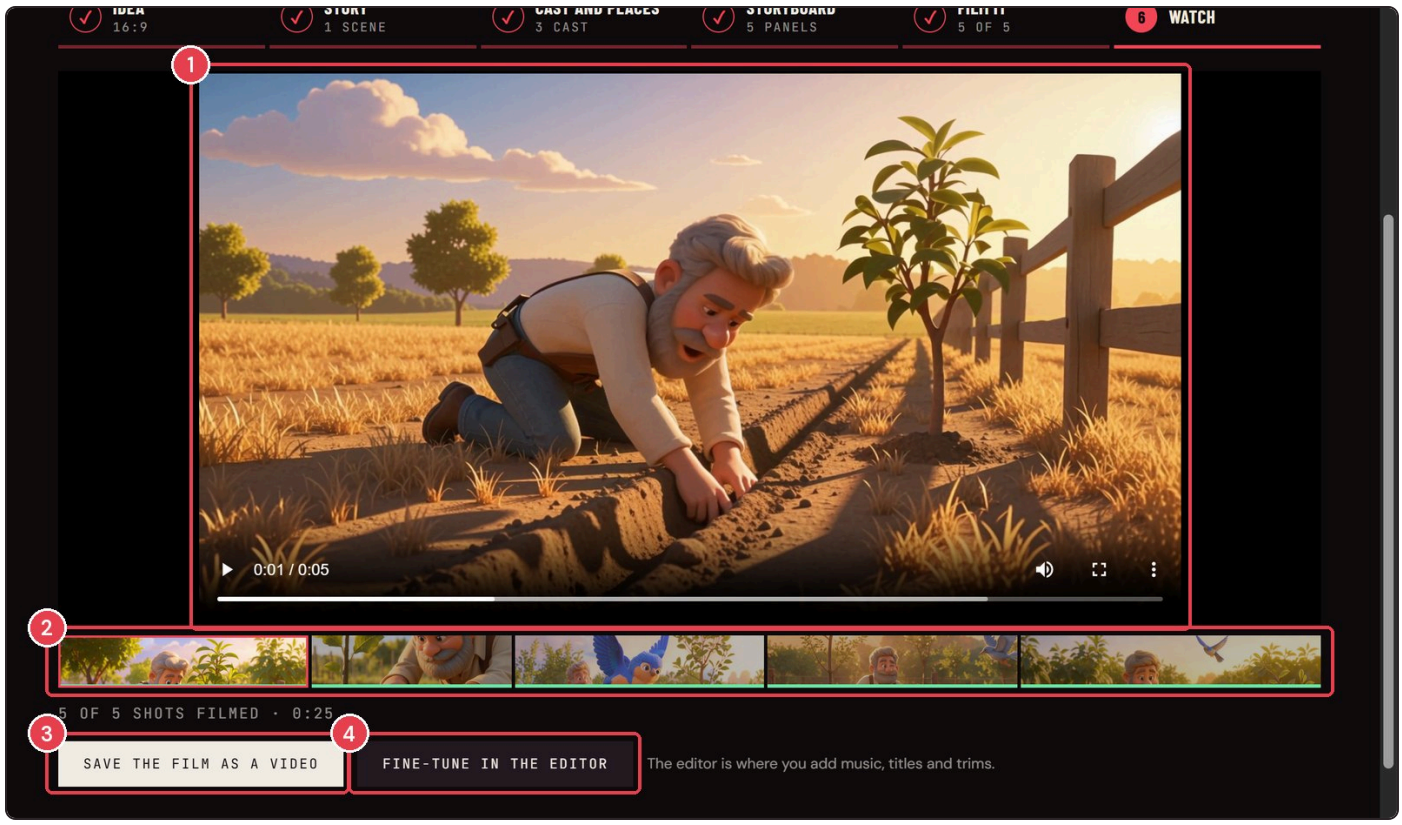
1. How many shots are done, waiting to be picked, and filming.
2. **Start each shot from its sketch:** keeps the storyboard's framing.
3. **2 takes** or **3 takes** per shot.
4. **Film every shot**, with the time it will take.
5. **Film this scene** to do one scene at a time.
6. The panels fill with takes as they render.

HOW TO PICK A TAKE FOR A SHOT



1. Watch the takes.
2. **Use take N** finishes it at full quality.
3. None right? **Open the shot** to change it, say the line again or film new takes.
4. **Close.**

6 · WATCH

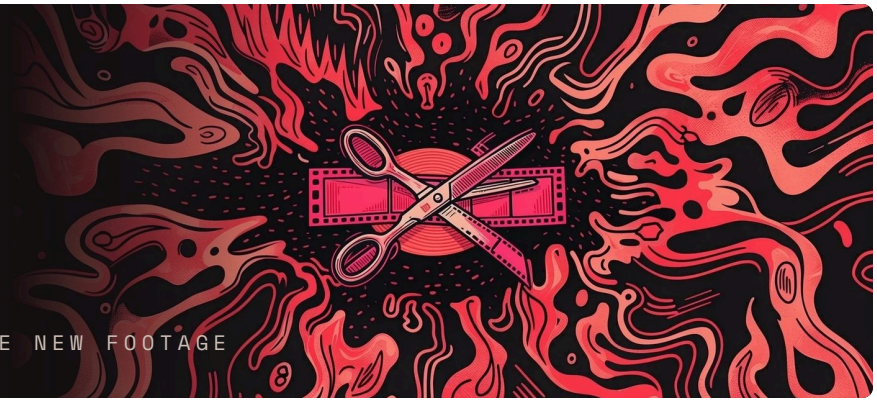


1. The film plays in order.
2. The strip of shots. Click one to jump to it.
3. **Save the film as a video** exports it to `Videos\IV Studio\Edits`.
4. **Fine-tune in the editor** opens it in Edit for music, titles and trims.

CHAPTER 08

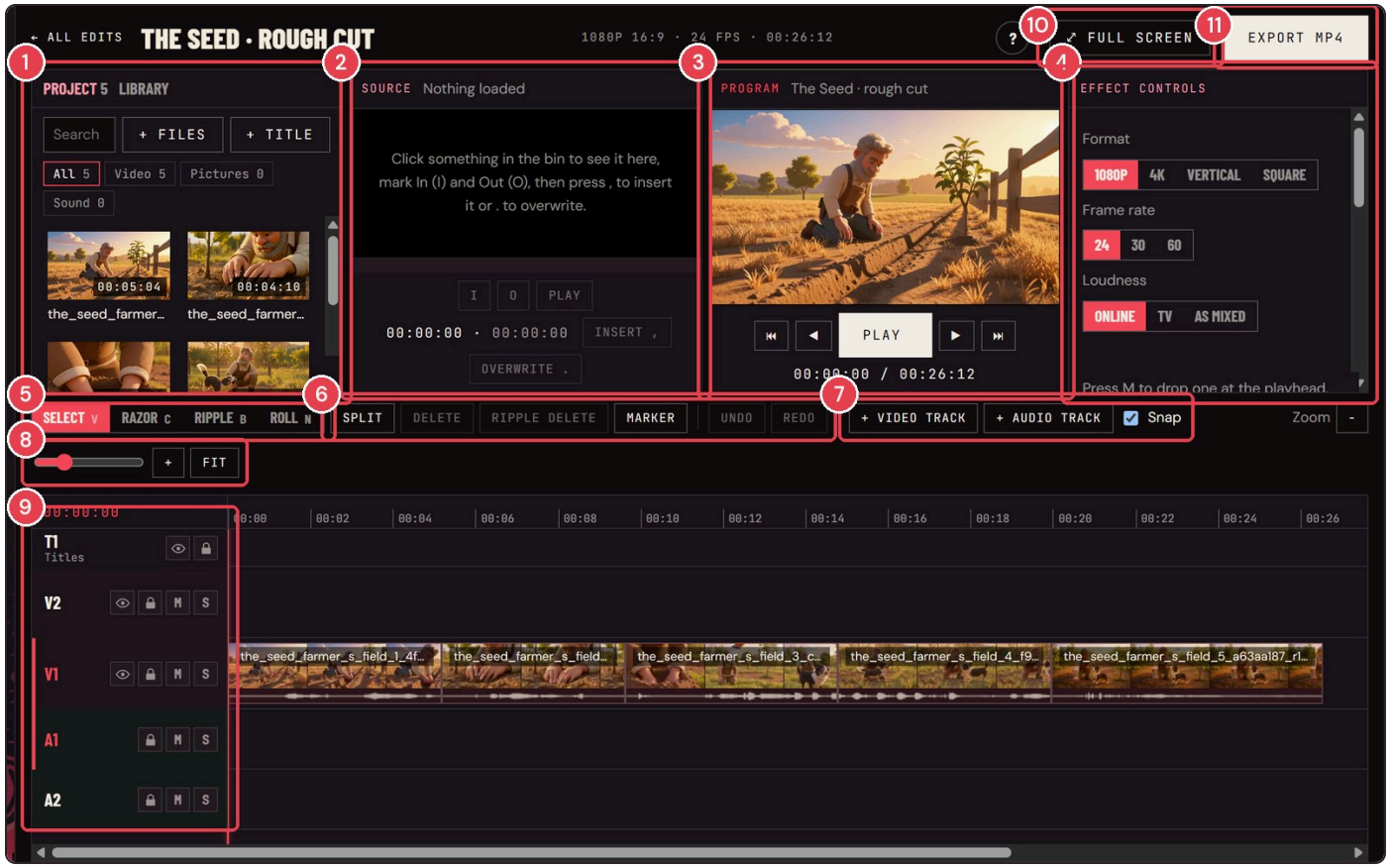
EDIT

A FULL EDITOR THAT CAN MAKE NEW FOOTAGE



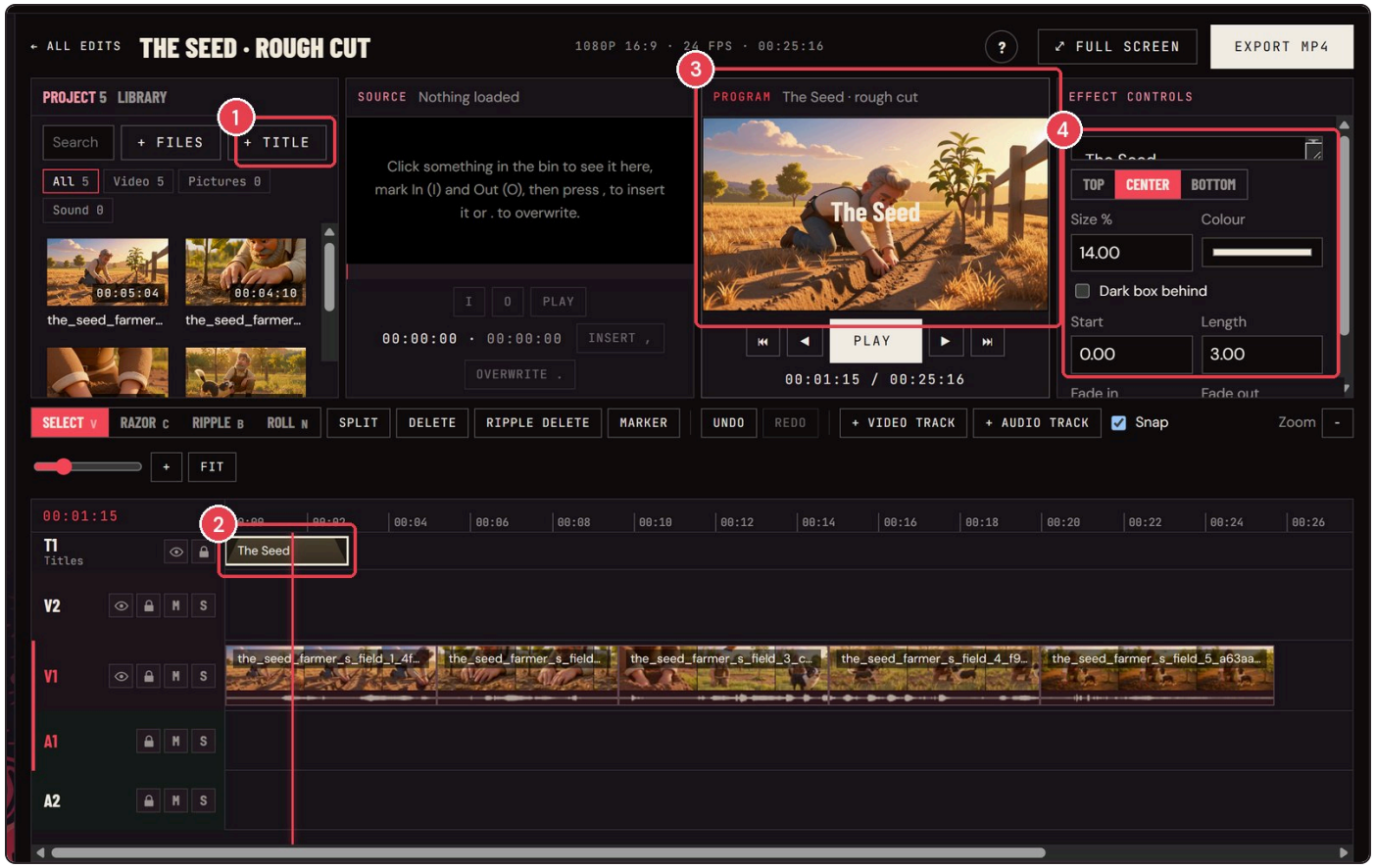
Open **Edit**, then an edit or **New edit**. The editor works like Adobe Premiere, with the same keys (Appendix A).

THE EDITOR



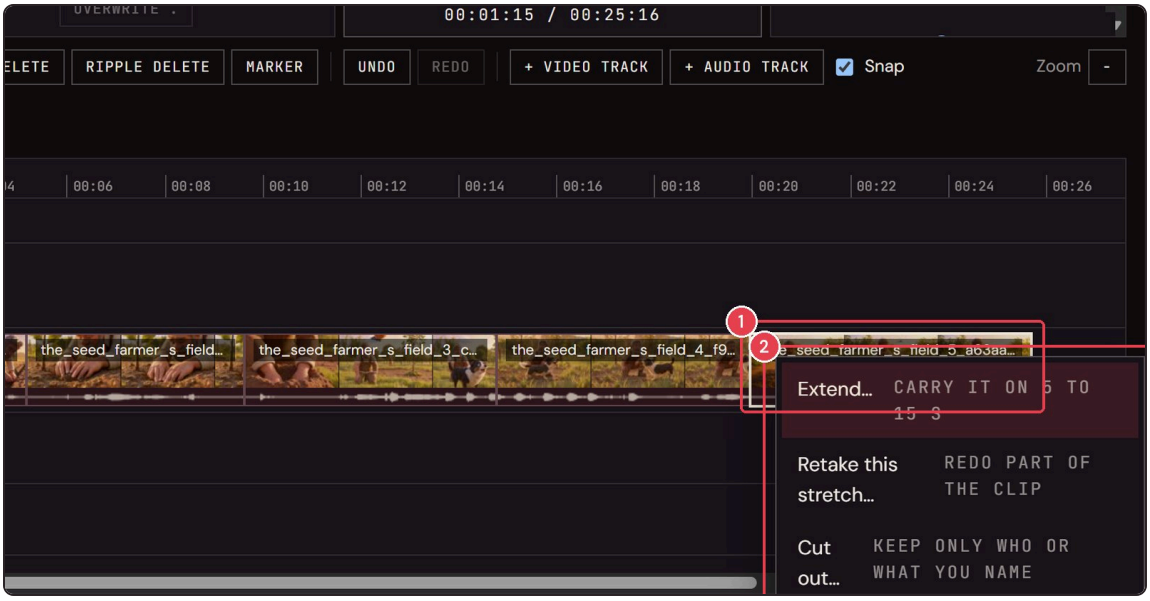
1. **Project bin:** your media. **+ Files** adds files, **+ Title** adds a title, **Library** lists every render.
2. **Source monitor:** plays a clip from the bin. Mark In `I` and Out `O`, then **Insert** `,` or **Overwrite** `.` onto the timeline.
3. **Program monitor:** plays the edit.
4. **Effect controls:** the selected clip's settings, or with nothing selected the edit's format, frame rate and loudness.
5. Tools: **Select** `V`, **Razor** `C`, **Ripple** `B`, **Roll** `N`.
6. **Split**, **Delete**, **Ripple delete**, **Marker**, **Undo** and **Redo**.
7. **+ Video track**, **+ Audio track** and **Snap**.
8. Zoom the timeline; **Fit** shows the whole edit.
9. Tracks. Each can be hidden (eye), locked, muted (M) or soloed (S).
10. **Full screen** (`F11`; `Esc` to return).
11. **Export MP4.**

HOW TO ADD A TITLE



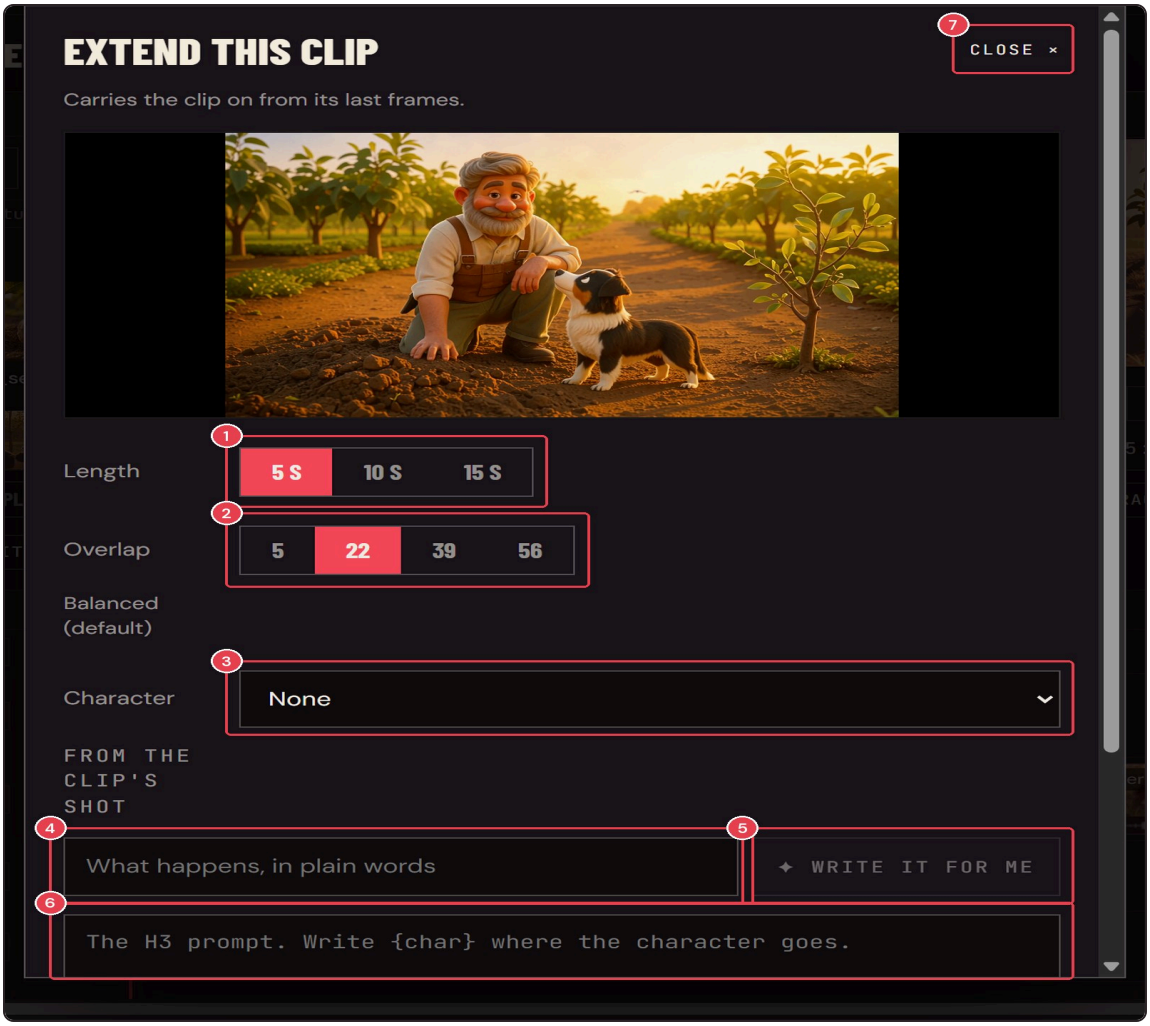
1. Press **+ Title** in the bin.
2. The title lands on the Titles track. Drag its ends to set how long it shows.
3. It shows over the picture in the program monitor.
4. Set its text, top / center / bottom, size, colour and an optional dark box.

HOW TO MAKE NEW FOOTAGE WITH A RIGHT-CLICK



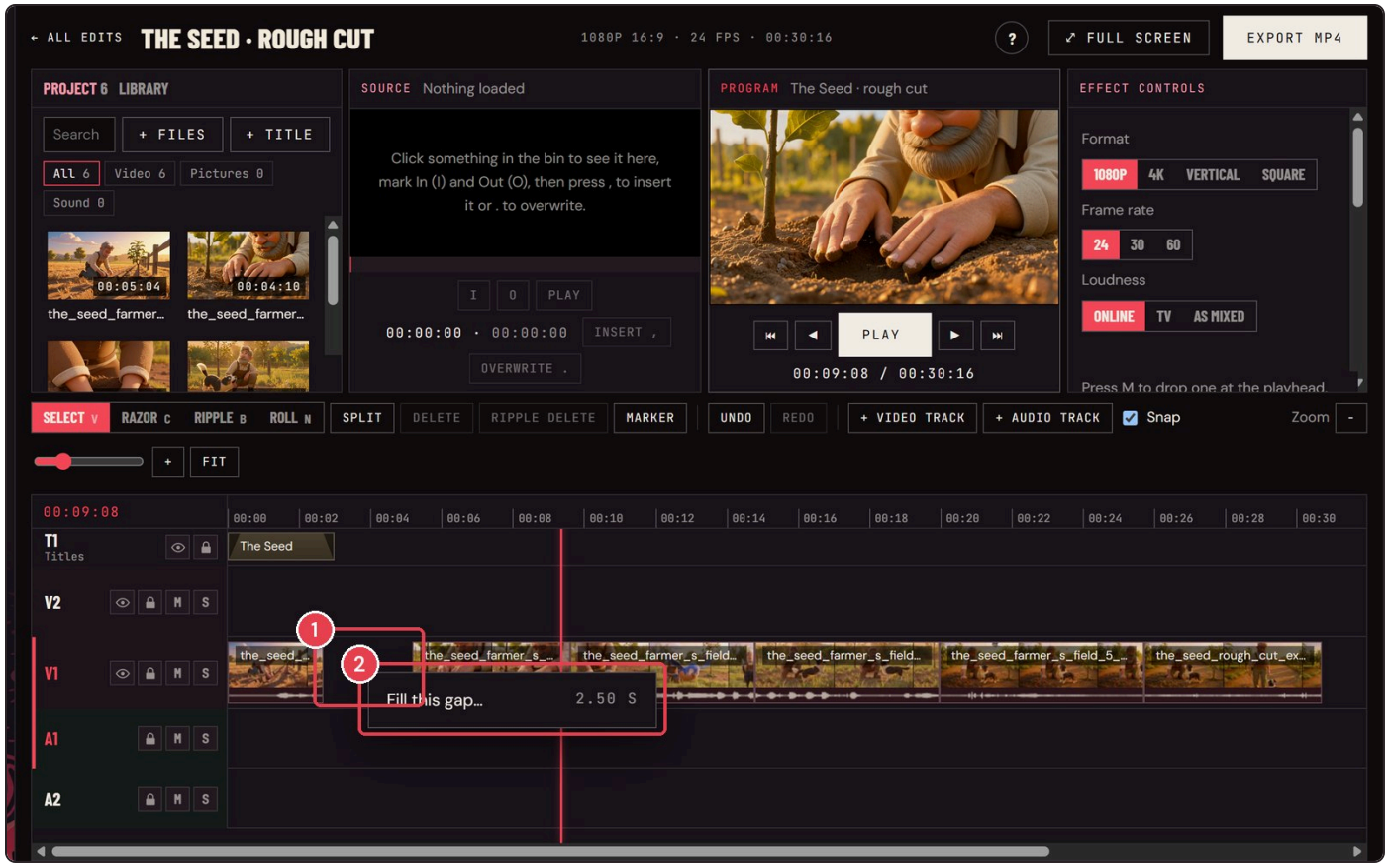
1. Right-click a clip on the timeline.
2. Choose **Extend…** (carry it on 5 to 15 s), **Retake this stretch…** (redo part of it), **Cut out…** (keep only who you name), **Bridge to the next clip…** or **Reframe to 9:16…**

HOW TO EXTEND A CLIP

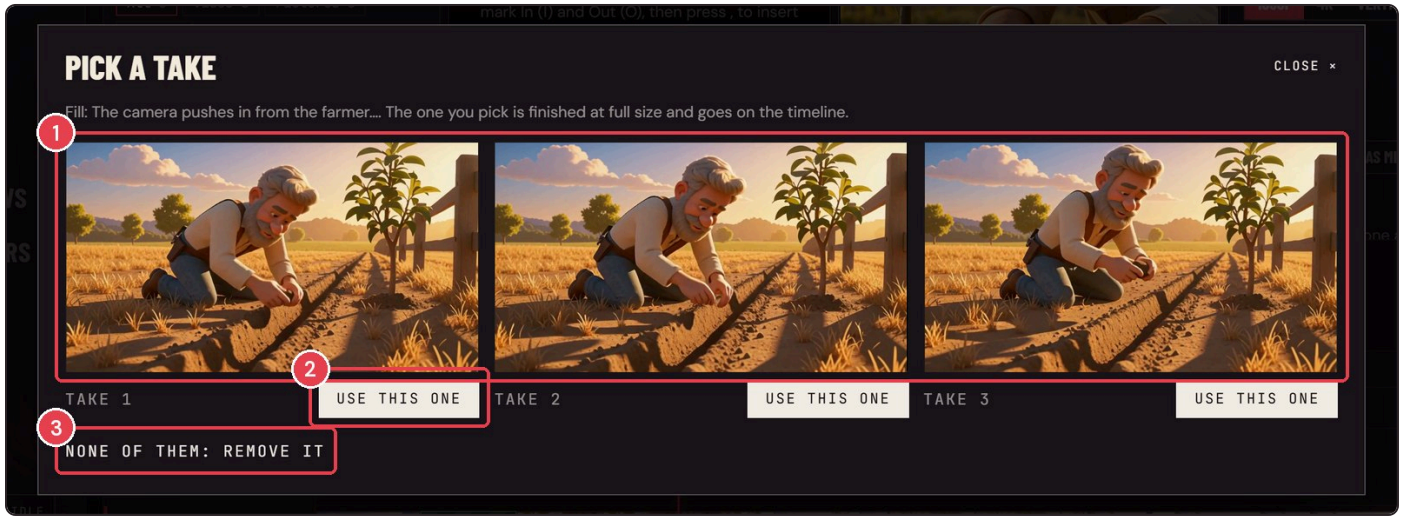


1. **Length** of the new part: 5, 10 or 15 s.
2. **Overlap:** how much of the old clip it continues from. 22 is balanced.
3. **Character**, if one is in it.
4. Say what happens next in plain words.
5. ✦ **Write it for me** writes the prompt, looking at the clip's last frames.
6. The H3 prompt. Press **Generate** at the bottom; a striped placeholder renders on the timeline.
7. **Close** without making anything.

HOW TO FILL A GAP BETWEEN TWO CLIPS

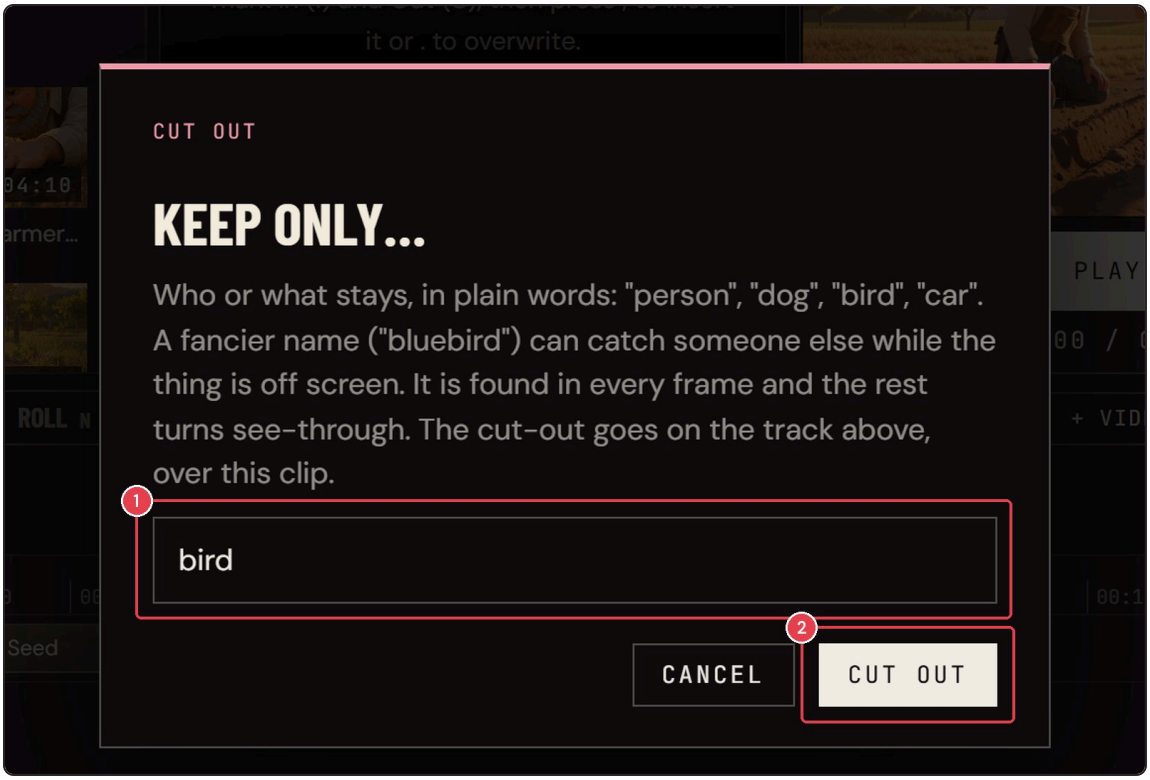


1. Leave a gap (up to 15 s) between two clips.
2. Right-click the gap and choose **Fill this gap…**. Describe it and generate, as for Extend.



1. Three takes, each starting on the left clip's last frame and ending on the right clip's first.
2. **Use this one** finishes your pick and puts it in the gap.
3. **None of them: remove it.**

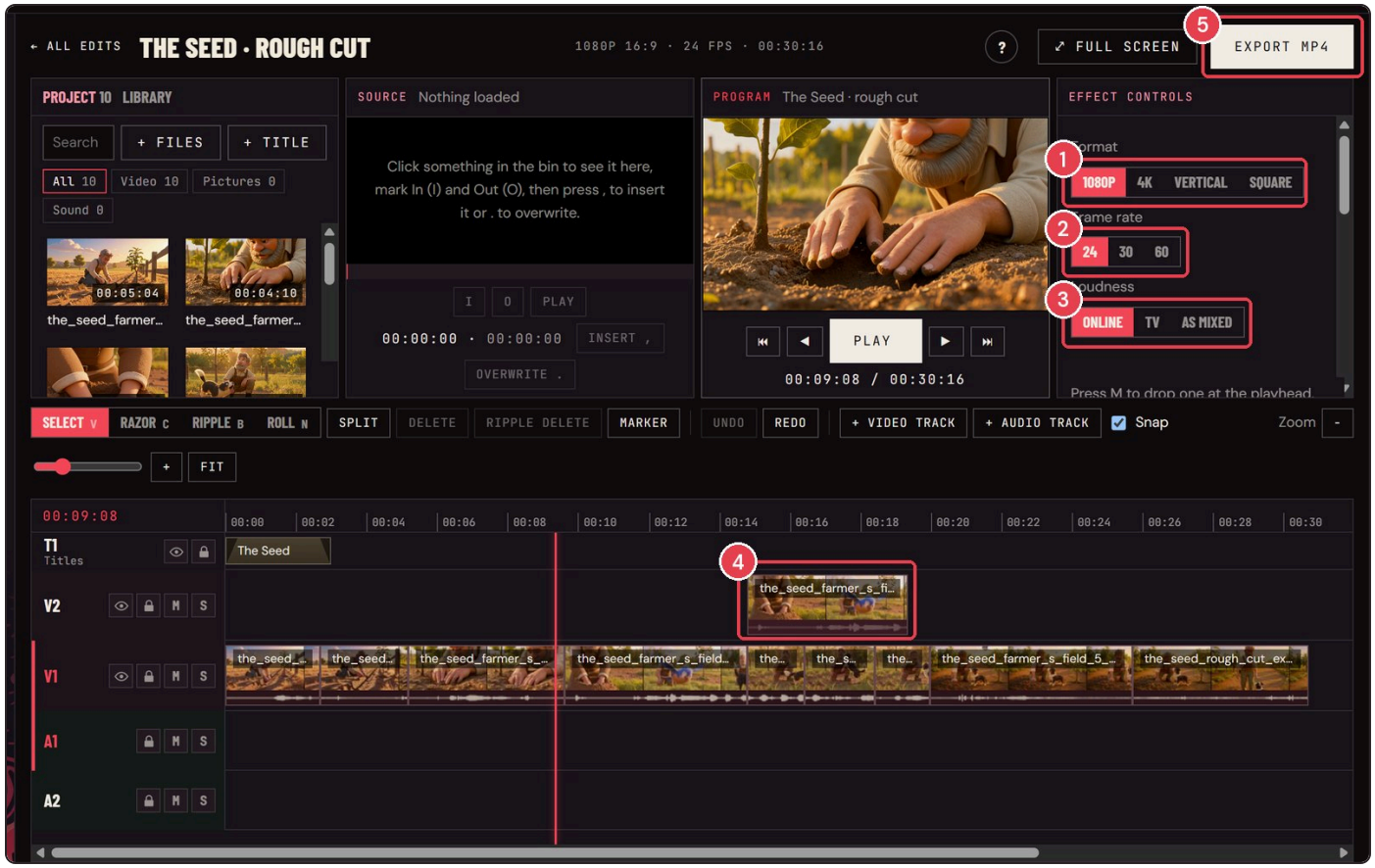
HOW TO CUT SOMEONE OUT



1. Right-click a clip, choose **Cut out…**, and type who or what stays in plain words: "person", "dog", "bird", "car".
2. Press **Cut out**. The rest turns see-through, and the cut-out goes on the track above.

> NEWEST BUILD
> Cut out and Reframe are in the newest build. Reframe works best on shots with one subject; on wide shots with several people it can paint extra copies of them.

HOW TO SET THE FORMAT, LOUDNESS AND EXPORT



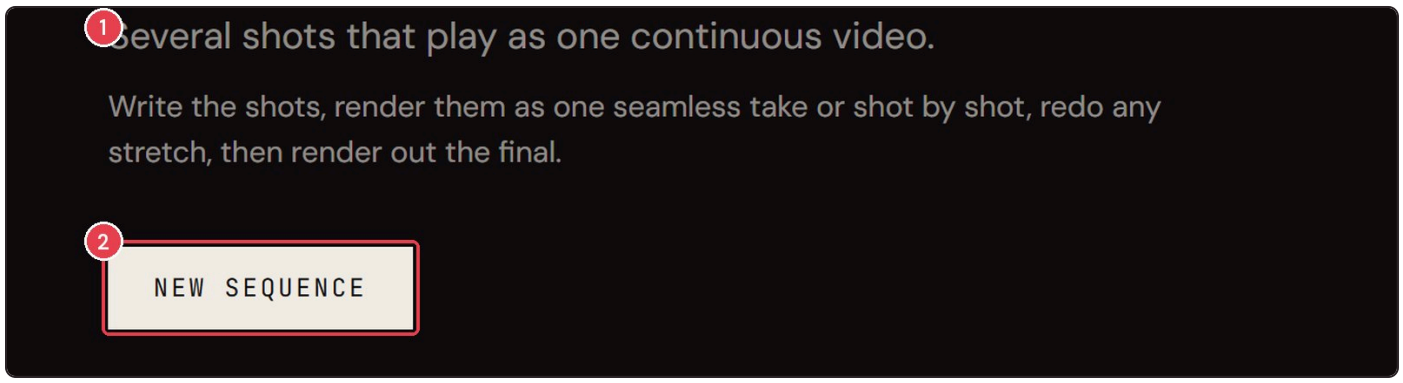
1. Click empty timeline, then **Format**: 1080p, 4K, vertical or square.
2. **Frame rate:** 24, 30 or 60.
3. **Loudness: Online** (about -14 LUFS, right for phones), **TV** (-23) or **As mixed**.
4. Clips on higher tracks are drawn over lower ones; this is a cut-out on V2.
5. **Export MP4.** The film goes to `Videos\IV Studio\Edits`.

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> If an agent changes an open edit, a strip shows what it did with one-click **Undo**. Agents can't touch locked tracks.



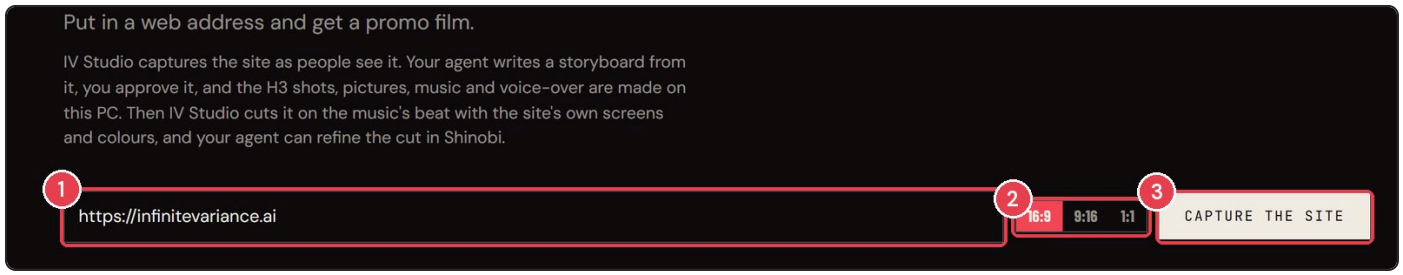
Open **Workflows** and click a card: Sequences, Sizzle, Reel, Shinobi or Replace.

SEQUENCES · A LONGER SCENE IN ONE TAKE



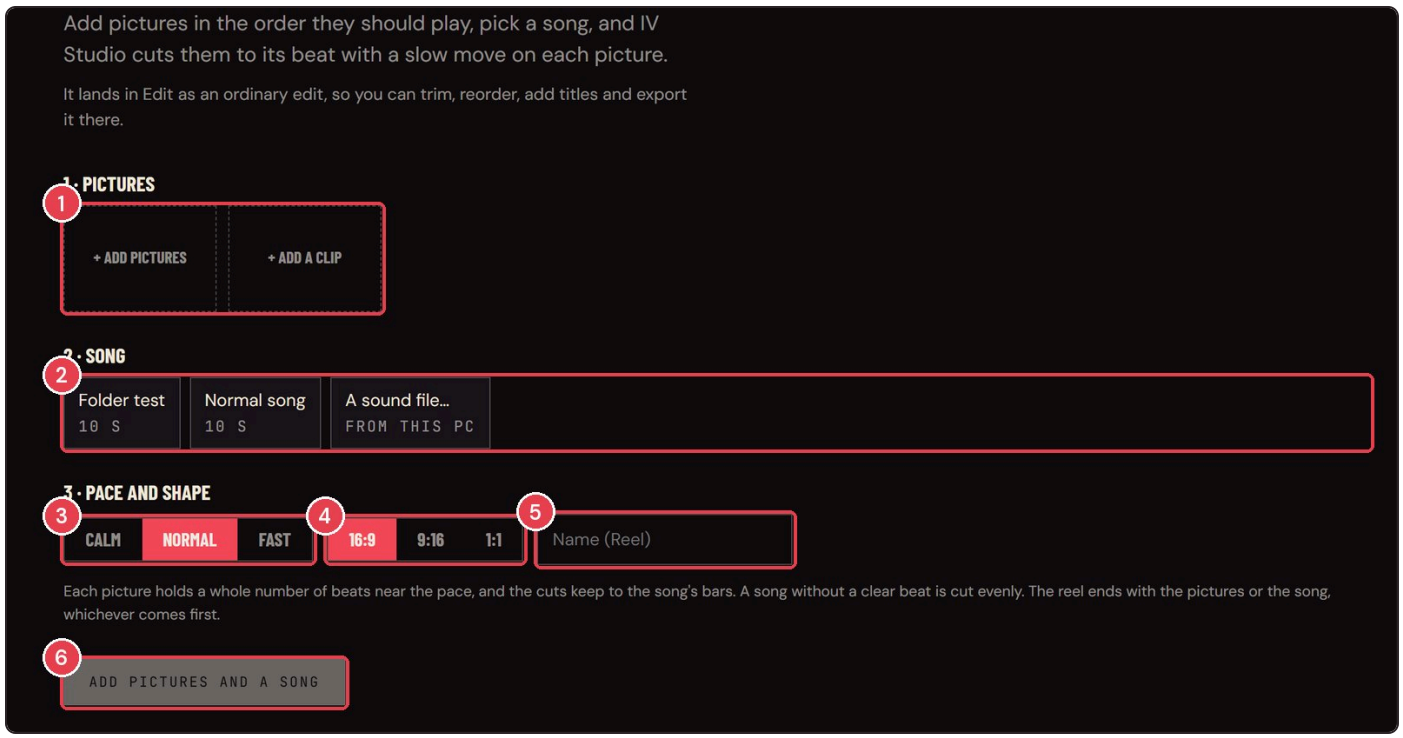
1. ← **Workflows** goes back to the cards.
2. **New sequence:** write each 10 or 15 s shot, then render the whole scene in one take or shot by shot. Retake any stretch, then **Render out** to finish it.

SIZZLE · A WEBSITE MADE INTO A FILM



1. Paste a web address.
2. Choose the shape: 16:9, 9:16 or 1:1.
3. **Capture the site.** IV Studio saves its screens, logo, colours, fonts and words. Your agent writes a storyboard; you approve it; IV Studio makes the pieces; **Cut it for me** makes the first edit.

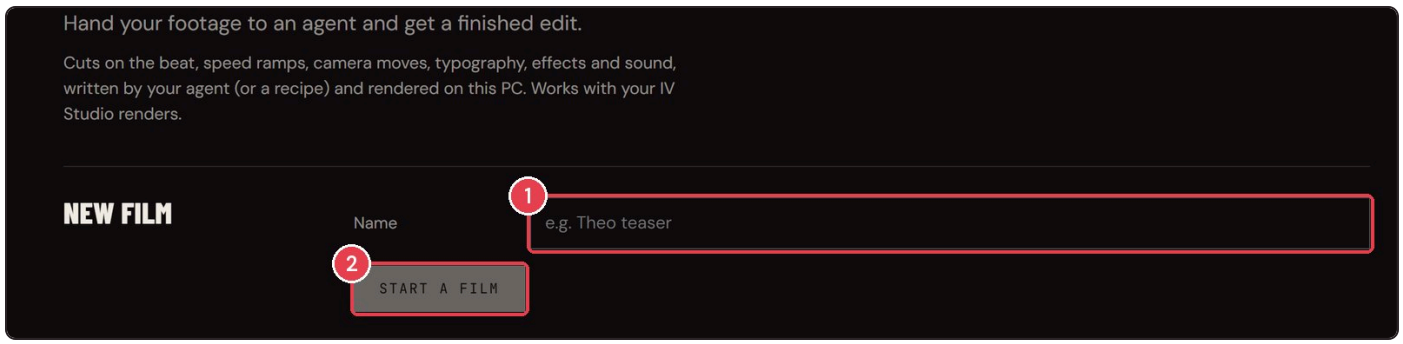
REEL · PICTURES AND A SONG, CUT TO THE BEAT



1. **+ Add pictures** or **+ Add a clip**, in the order they should play.
2. Pick a song you made, or **A sound file…** from this PC.
3. Pace: **Calm**, **Normal** or **Fast**.
4. Shape: 16:9, 9:16 or 1:1.
5. A name.
6. Press the button. IV Studio finds the beat, cuts on it with a slow move on each picture, and opens the reel in Edit.

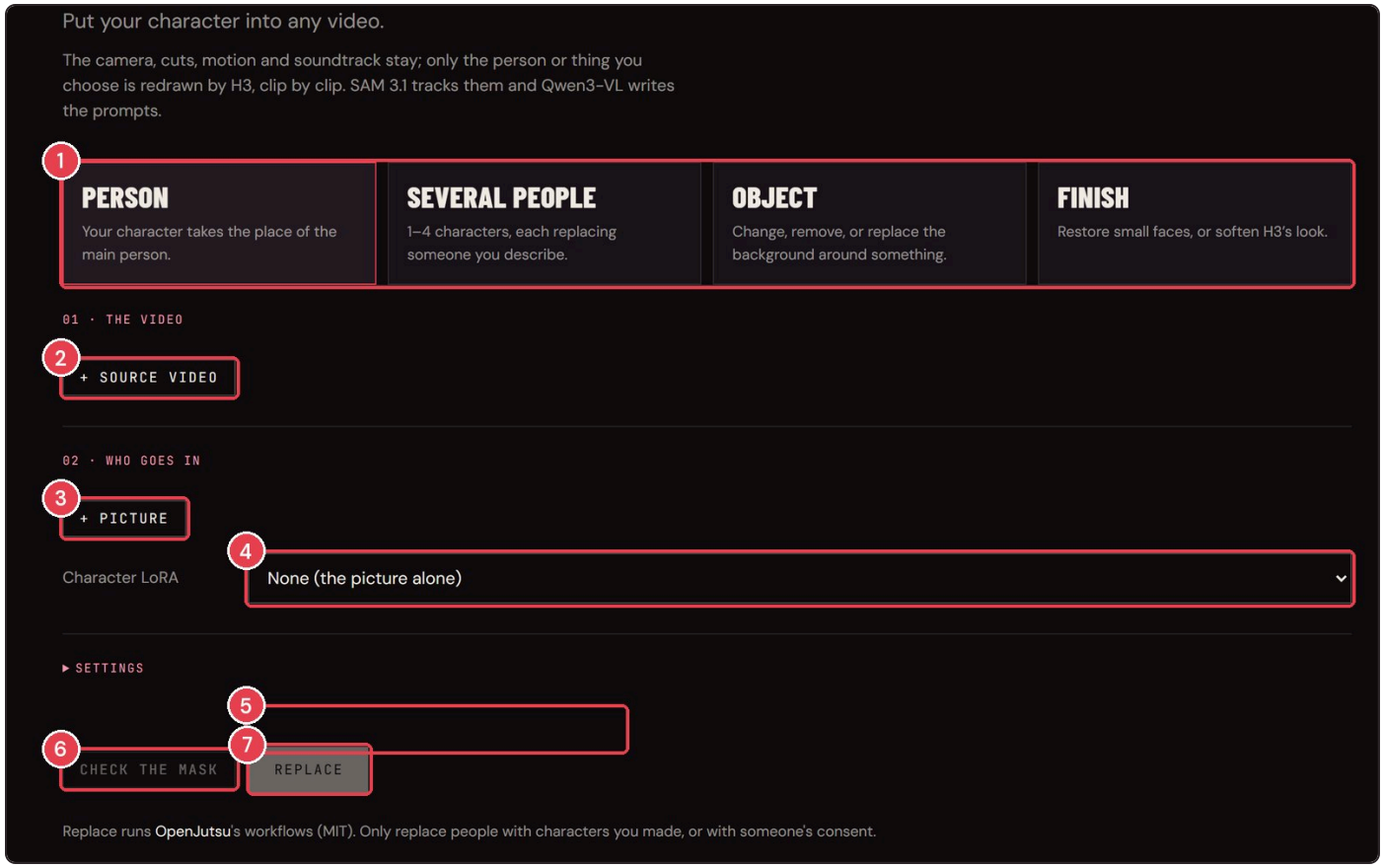
> NEWEST BUILD
> Reel is in the newest build.

SHINOBI · AN EDIT YOUR AGENT CUTS



1. Name the film.
2. **Start a film.** Add a brief and media, then choose a one-click style or hand it to your agent. Renders go to Edit.

REPLACE · SWAP WHO IS IN THE SHOT



1. What to do: **Person**, **Several people**, **Object** or **Finish** (restore faces and colours).
2. **+ Source video:** the video to change. It needs a sound track.
3. **+ Picture:** who goes in.
4. Or pick one of your characters, whose LoRA joins the run.
5. The render size.
6. **Check the mask** shows what will be replaced, quickly.
7. **Replace.**

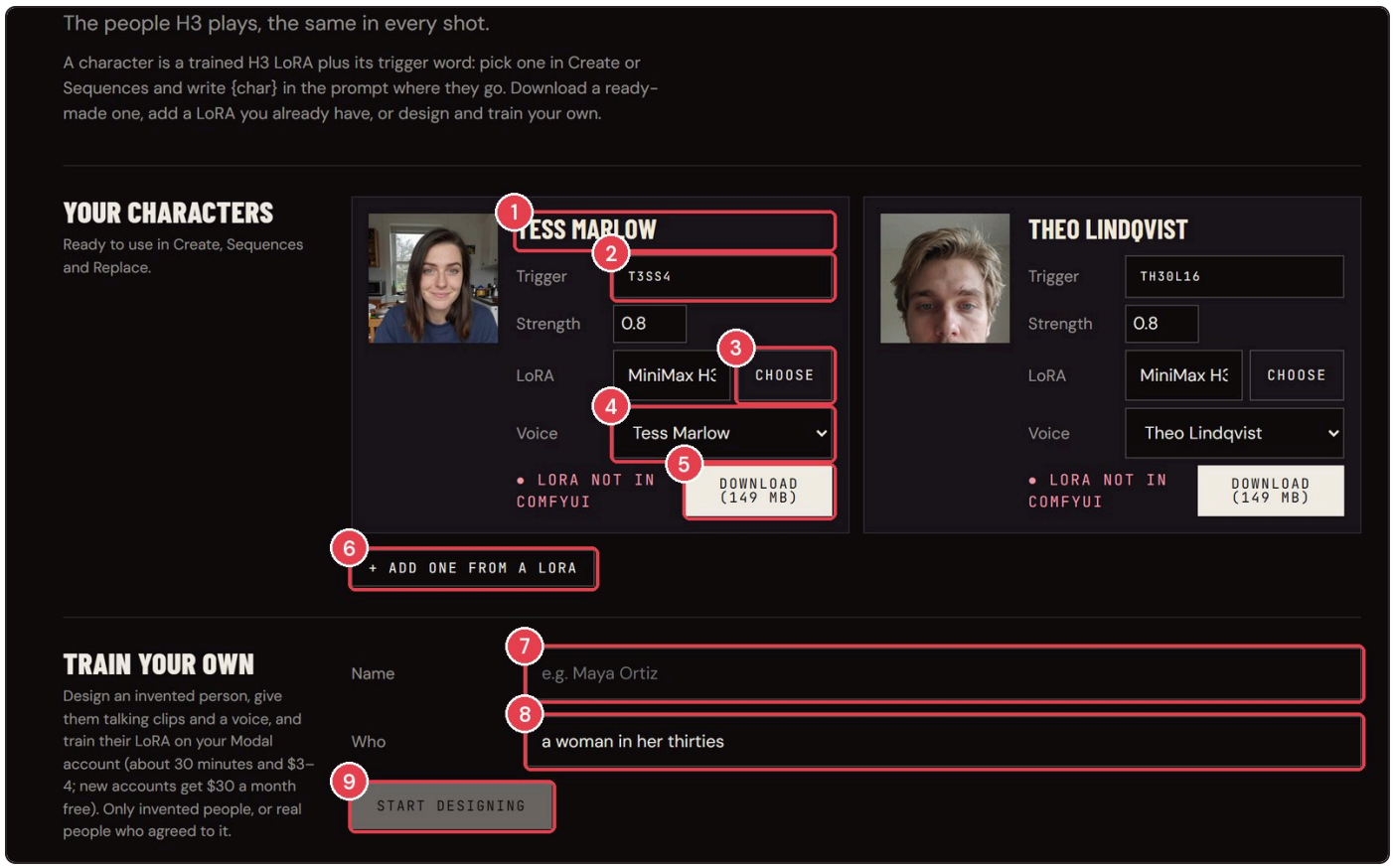
CHAPTER 10

CHARACTERS

THE SAME FACE IN EVERY SHOT



HOW TO SET UP AND MAKE CHARACTERS



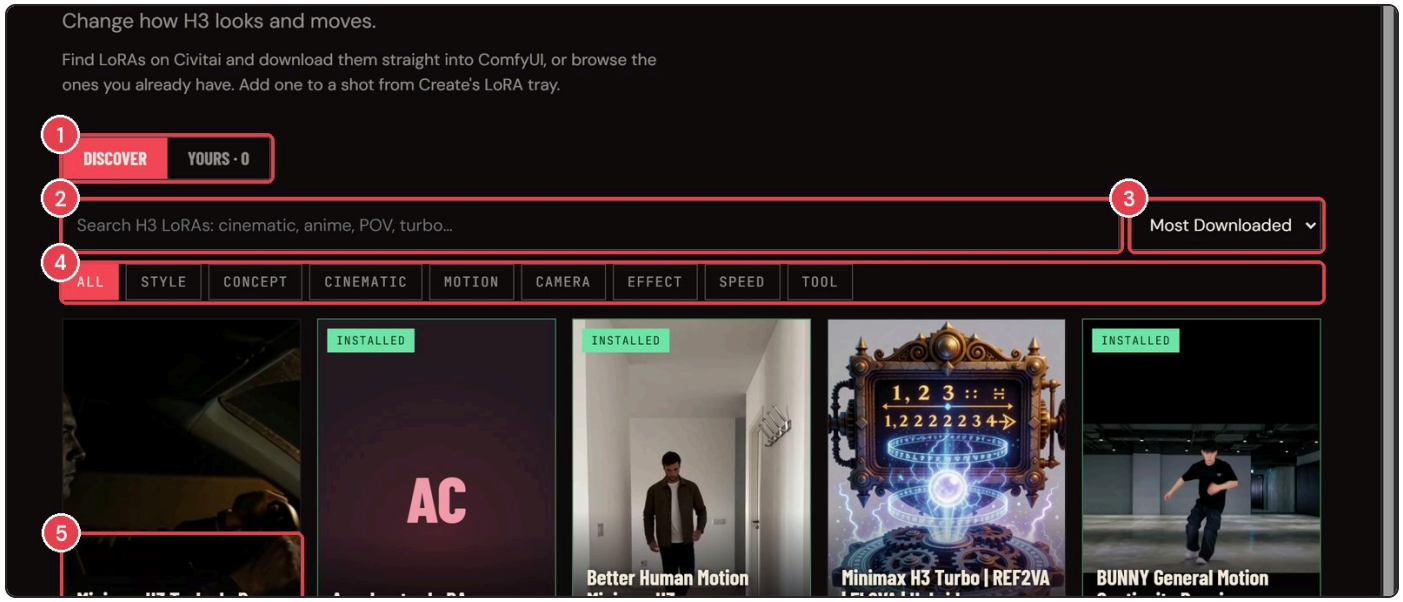
1. **Trigger:** the word that calls the character in a prompt (IV Studio writes it for you as `{char}`).
2. **Strength:** how strongly the LoRA is applied.
3. **Choose** another LoRA file.
4. **Voice:** the voice they speak in.
5. **Download** the LoRA if it isn't in ComfyUI yet.
6. **+ Add one from a LoRA:** make a character from a LoRA you already have.
7. **Train your own:** a name.
8. Who they are, in a few words.
9. **Start designing.** Then **Make four faces** (and more until one is right), pick the face, let IV Studio make talking clips, and train on your own Modal account. The cost shows before it starts. Finally pick the best checkpoint and it becomes a character.

CHAPTER 11

LORAS

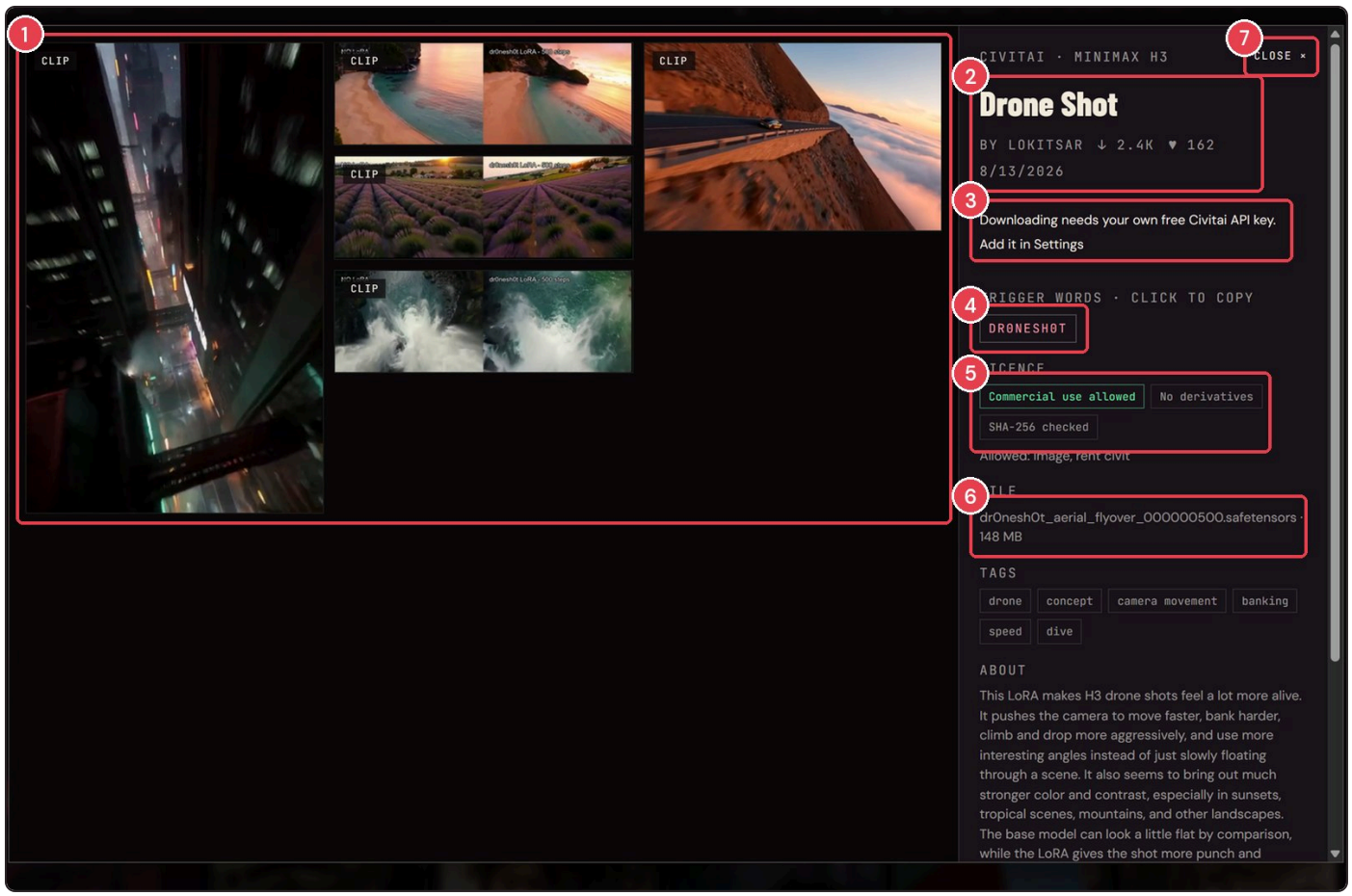
LOOKS, MOVES AND STYLES

HOW TO FIND LORAS



1. **Discover** (on Civitai) or **Yours** (already in ComfyUI).
2. Search, for example "cinematic", "anime", "turbo".
3. Sort, for example **Most Downloaded**.
4. Filter by tag: style, concept, cinematic, motion, camera and more.
5. A LoRA card. Hover to play its clip; **Installed** marks ones you have. Click it for details.

A LORA'S DETAILS

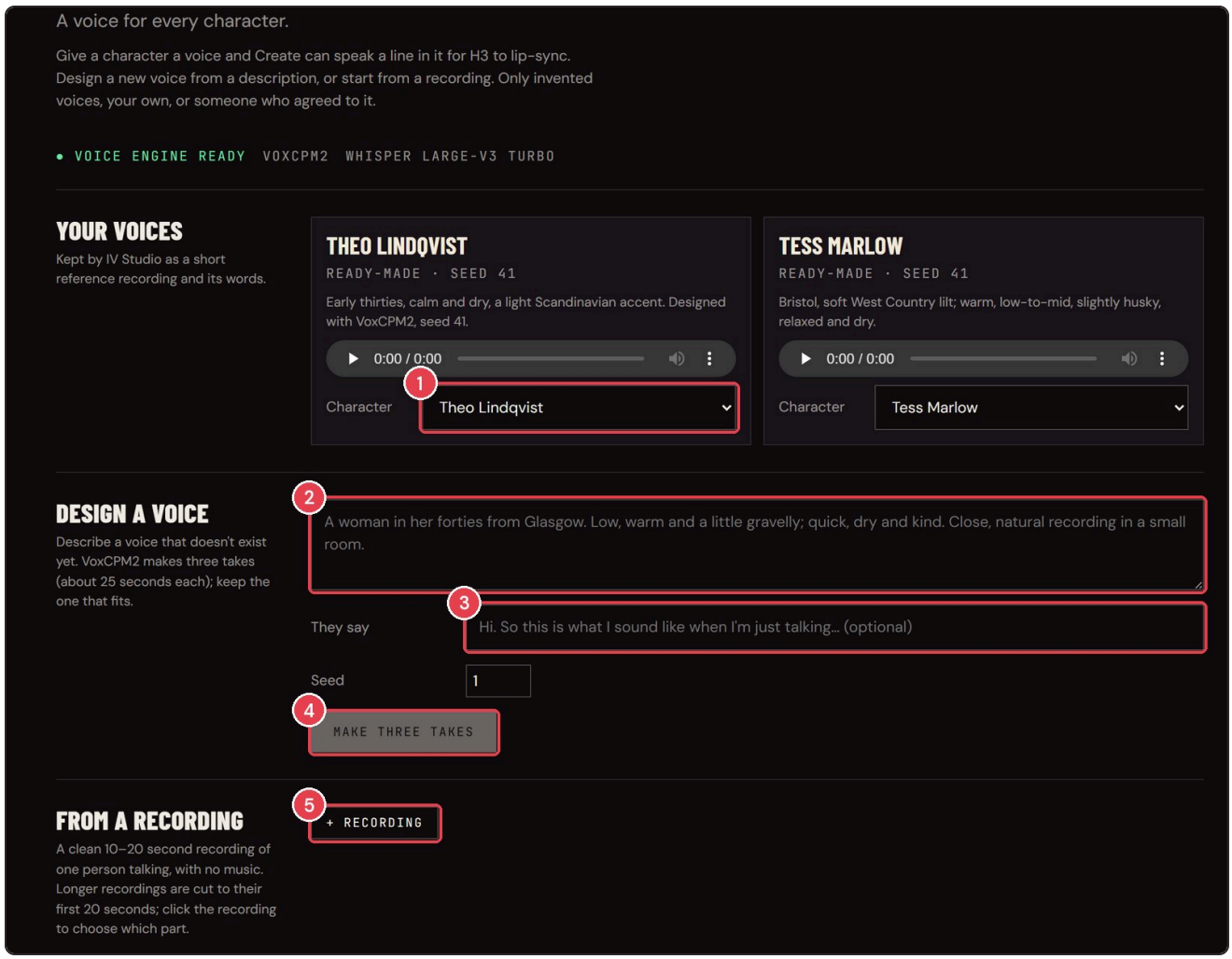


1. Its previews. Click one for a full view with the prompt used.
2. The name, maker and stats.
3. **Download** goes here once your Civitai key is saved (Settings → Civitai). Then **Use in a shot**.
4. Trigger words. Click to copy.
5. What the licence allows.
6. The file and its size.
7. **Close** (or `Esc`).



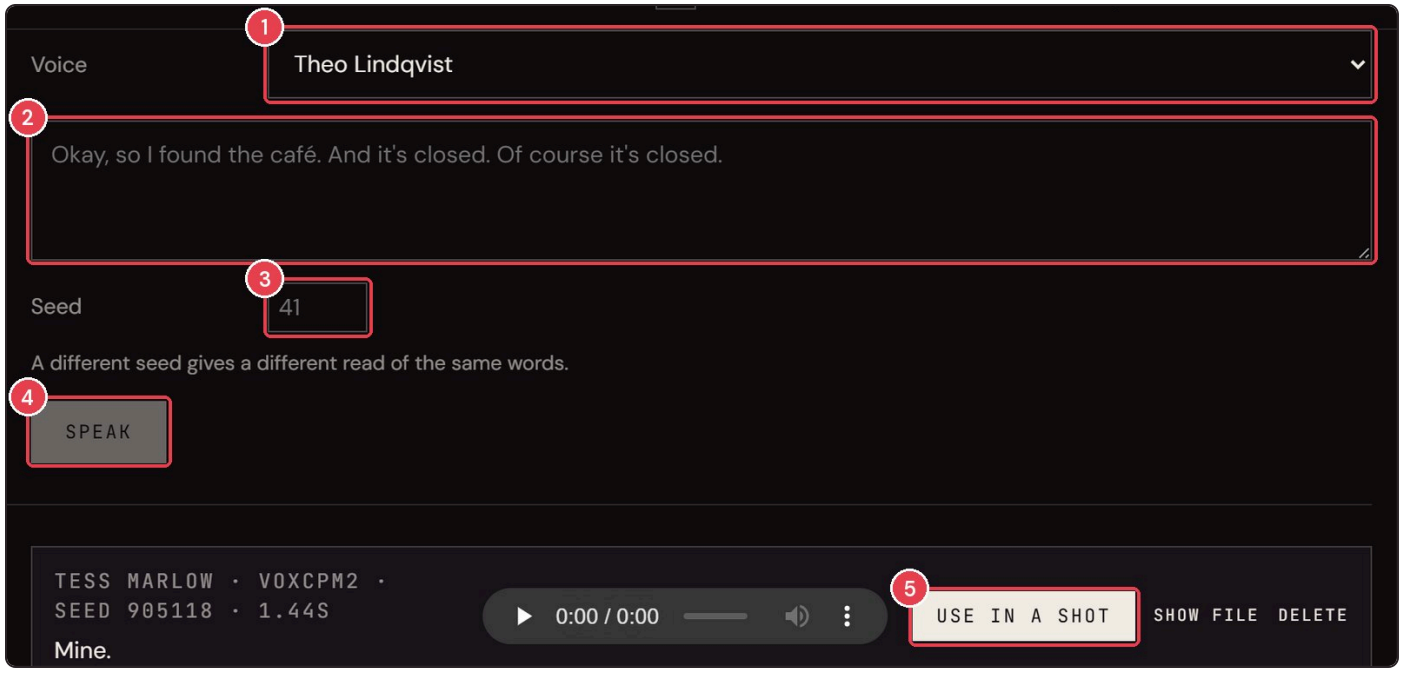
Switch the sidebar to **Audio**. The first time, press **Set up voices** on Voices (a one-time download of about 12 GB).

HOW TO DESIGN A VOICE



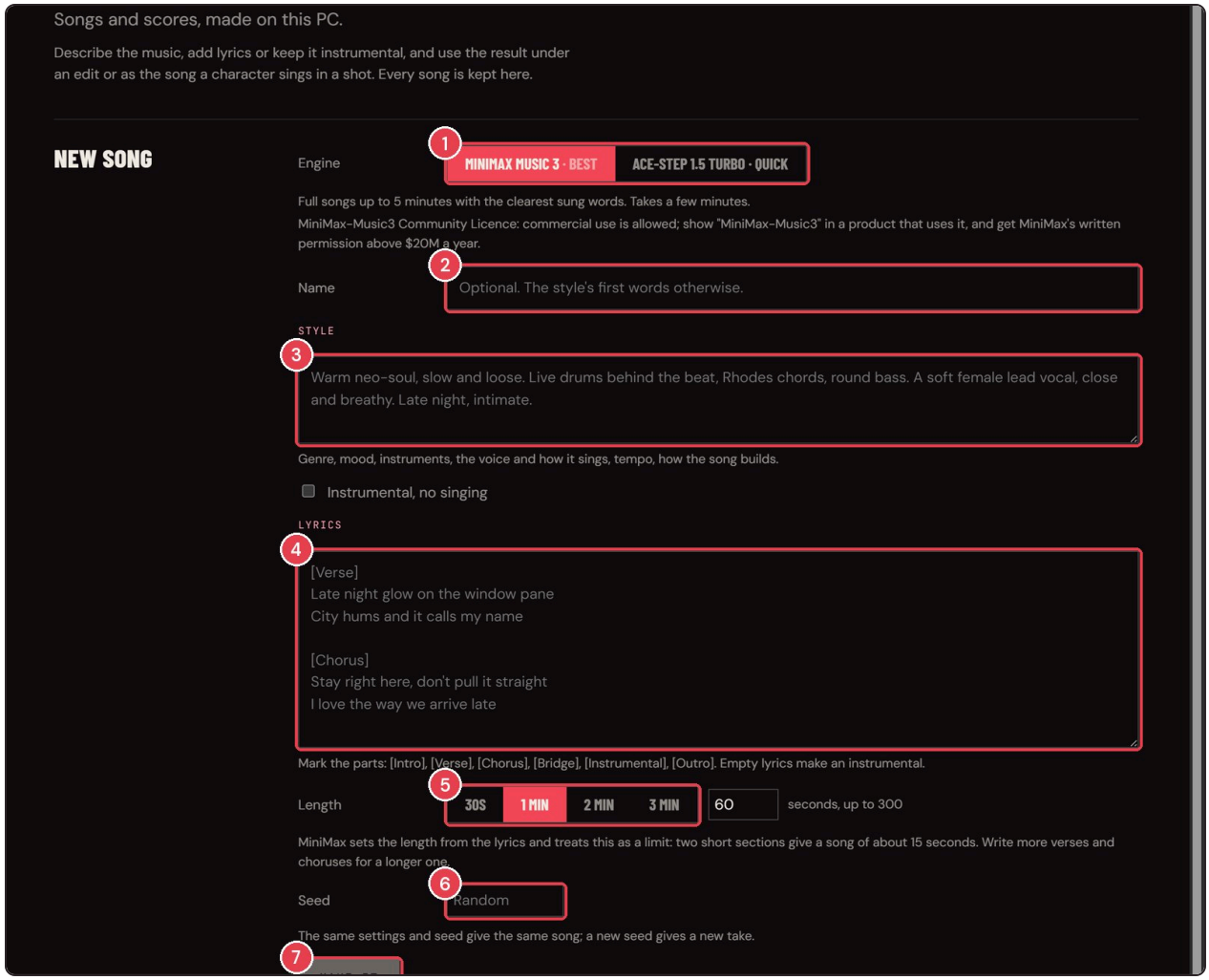
1. Each saved voice plays here. **Character** gives it to a character.
2. Describe a new voice: age, accent, tone, pace.
3. Optionally, the words for it to say.
4. **Make three takes**, then keep the one you like.
5. **+ Recording:** save a voice from a recording of someone who has agreed (tick the consent box, then **Save voice**).

HOW TO SAY A LINE



1. Choose the voice.
2. Type what they say.
3. A seed. A different seed gives a different read.
4. **Speak.**
5. **Use in a shot** sends the line to Create as the voice line.

HOW TO MAKE A SONG



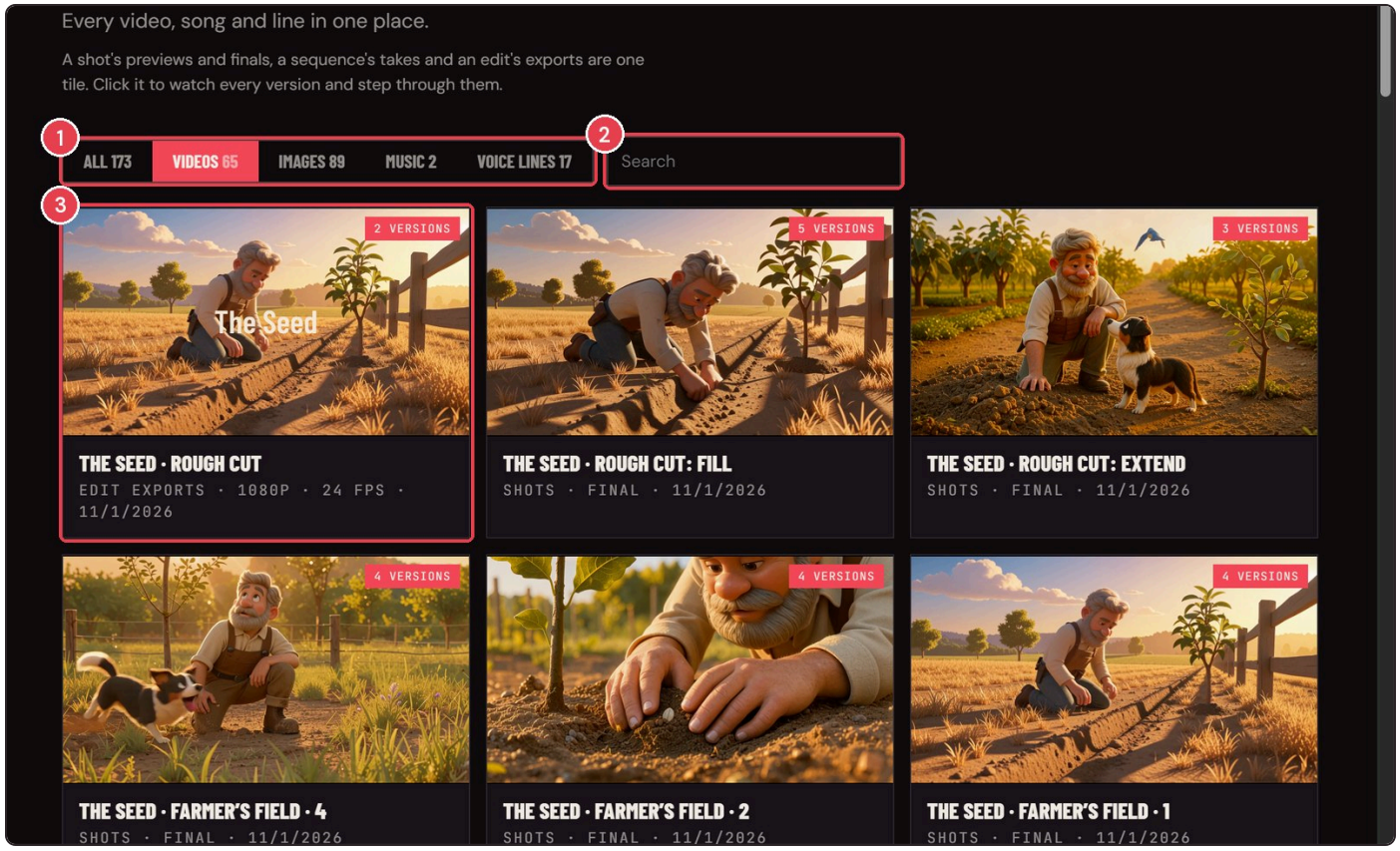
1. **MiniMax Music 3** (clearest sung words) or **ACE-Step 1.5 Turbo** (quick drafts).
2. A name (optional).
3. **Style:** genre, mood, instruments, the voice and how it sings, tempo.
4. **Lyrics,** with parts marked [Verse], [Chorus], [Bridge], [Instrumental], [Outro]. Leave empty, or tick **Instrumental, no singing**, for an instrumental.
5. **Length,** up to 5 minutes. With MiniMax, the length follows the lyrics.
6. A seed (optional).
7. **Make it.** The song appears below with **Use in a shot** and **Add to edit**.

CHAPTER 13

LIBRARY

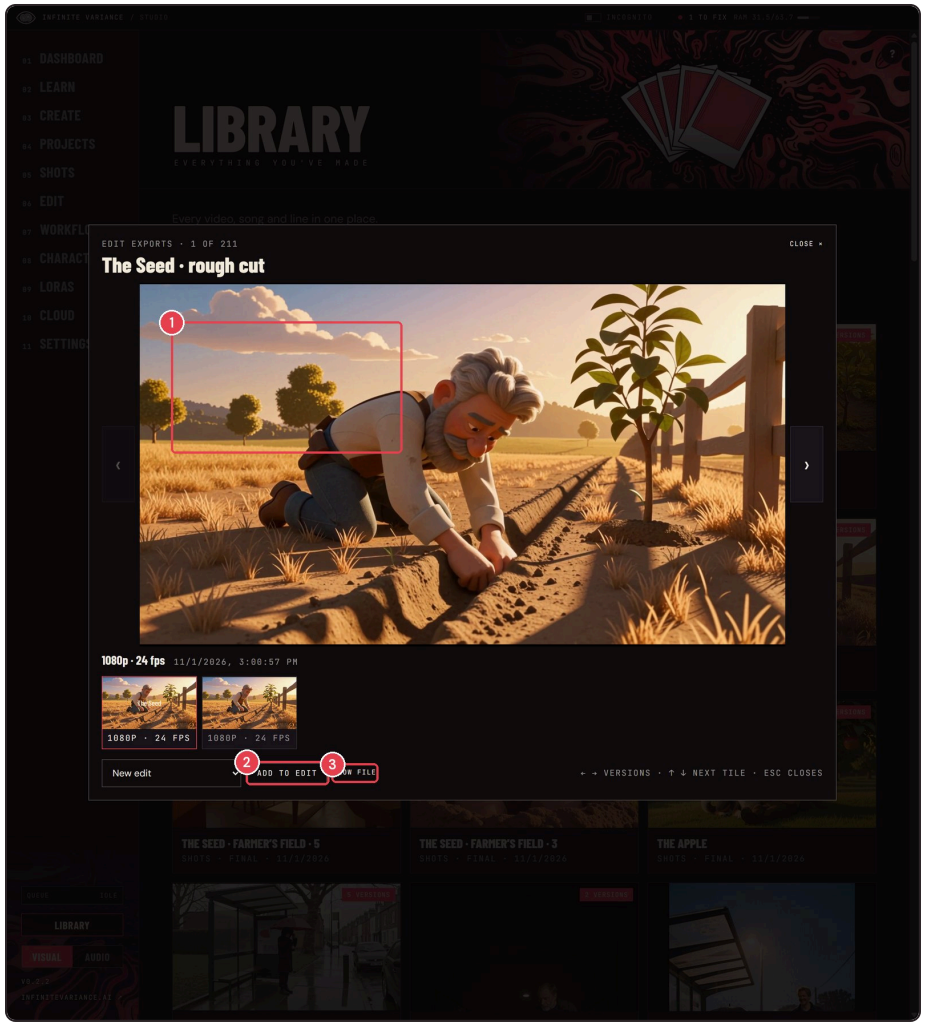
EVERYTHING YOU'VE MADE

HOW TO FIND SOMETHING YOU MADE



1. Filter: **All**, **Videos**, **Images**, **Music** or **Voice lines**.
2. Search by name.
3. A tile. All of a shot's versions share one tile; the badge says how many.

THE VIEWER



1. The player. ← → step through versions, ↑ ↓ through tiles, Esc closes.
2. **Add to edit** (choose the edit beside it).
3. **Show file.** Shots also have **Use in a shot** and **Open shot**.



No strong graphics card? Cloud renders on a GPU in your own Modal account. Modal bills by the second, shuts the GPU down when idle, and new accounts get $30 a month free.

HOW TO SET UP THE CLOUD



1. **My PC** or **Cloud:** where renders run. Switch to Cloud once set up.
2. **Install the cloud tools** (about 100 MB, in IV Studio's own folder).
3. **Create an account** if you need one, then **Sign in with Modal**.
4. Choose a GPU: L40S, A100 or H100, each with its price per hour.
5. **Shut down after** how many idle minutes.
6. **Set up the cloud.** It builds IV Studio's cloud app and copies the models to your Modal storage.

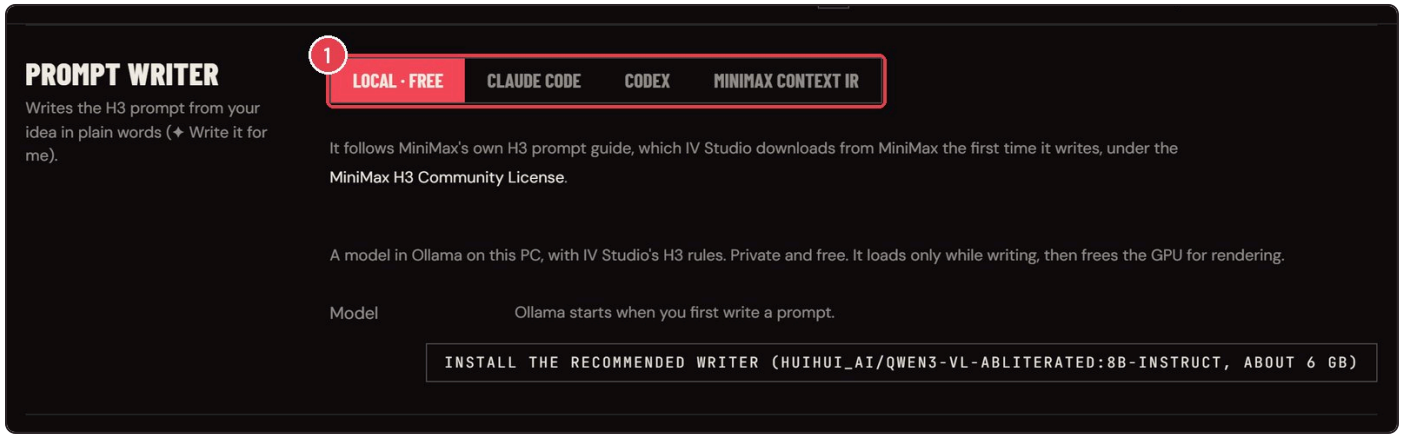
> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> In cloud mode the title bar shows the GPU, its running time and cost; click it to come here, where **Shut down GPU** stops it at once. Pictures, music, voices, character design, Replace, live previews, SeedVR2 and DLSS 5 still need this PC's NVIDIA card.

CHAPTER 15

SETTINGS

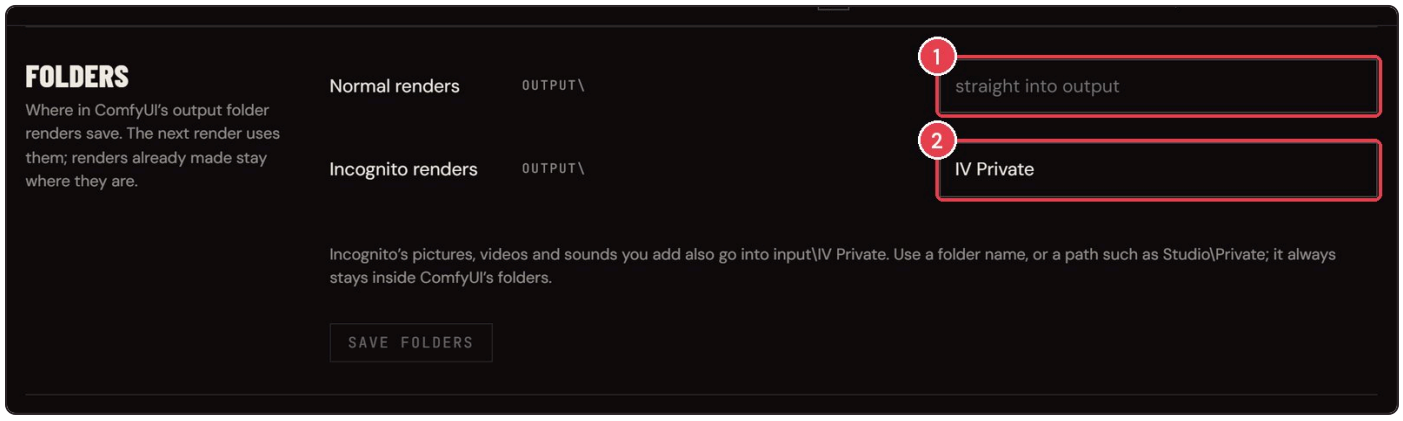
EVERY SETTING IN ONE PLACE

HOW TO CHOOSE THE PROMPT WRITER



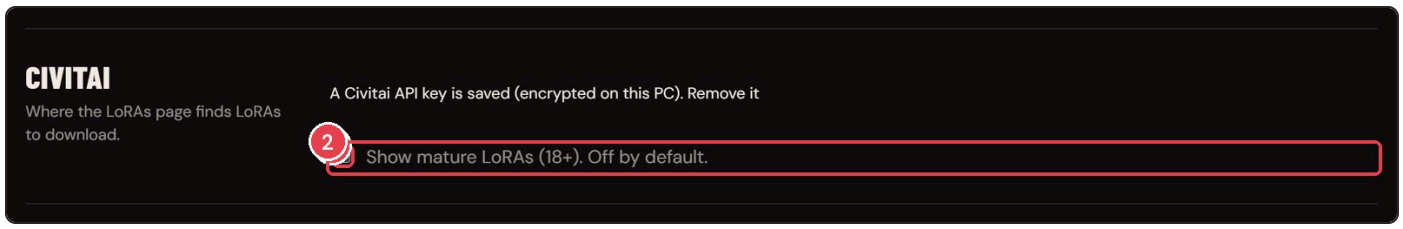
1. **Local · free** (on this PC, through Ollama), **Claude Code** or **Codex** (your own logins; the best prompts and reviews), or **MiniMax Context IR** (paid, a few cents a prompt). Below it, choose the model.

HOW TO CHOOSE WHERE RENDERS SAVE



1. **Normal renders:** a folder inside ComfyUI's output (empty saves straight into `output`).
2. **Incognito renders:** a separate folder (default `IV Private`). Press **Save folders**.

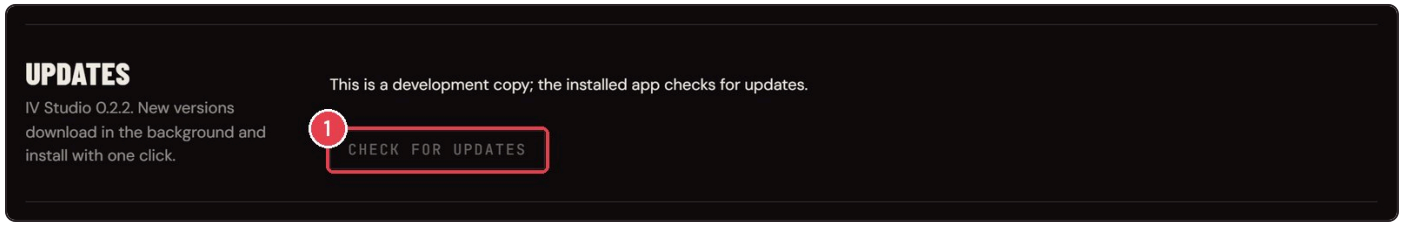
HOW TO CONNECT CIVITAI



Paste your free Civitai API key into the box and save it (it's stored encrypted; here a key is already saved, with **Remove it**).

2 **Show mature LoRAs (18+)** is off by default and asks you to confirm your age.

HOW TO UPDATE IV STUDIO



1 **Check for updates.** New versions also download by themselves; ↻ **Update to …** appears in the sidebar, and **Restart to update** installs it.

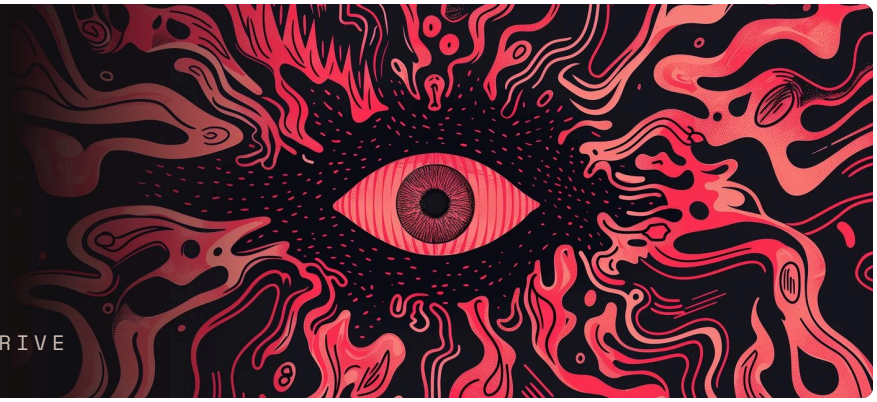
INCOGNITO

The **Incognito** switch in the title bar restarts IV Studio into a separate private space. Nothing made there shows in the normal app, and nothing normal shows there. Renders save into the Incognito folder above, and leaving clears its prompts from ComfyUI's history. It keeps work apart; it doesn't encrypt files.

CHAPTER 16

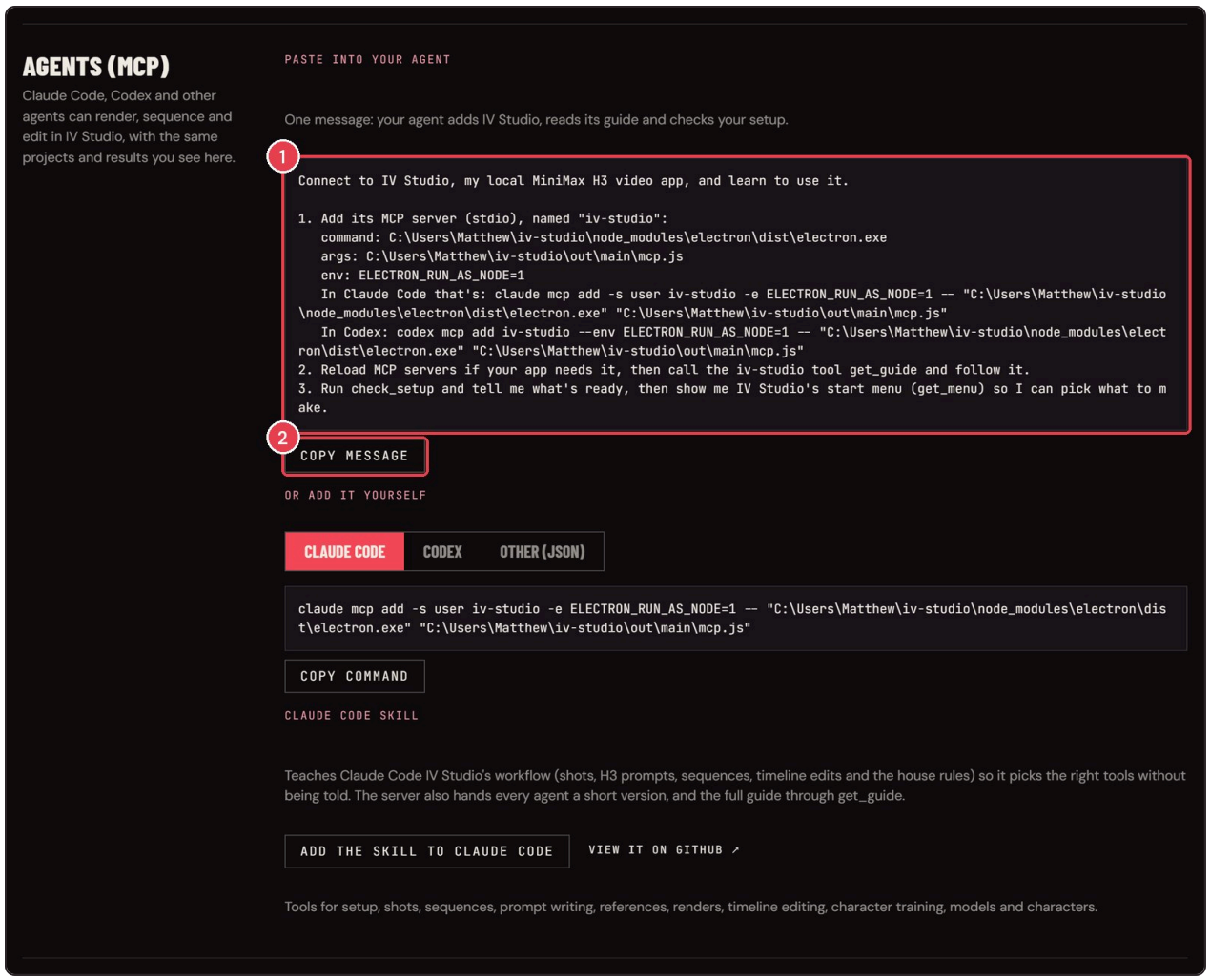
AGENTS

LET CLAUDE CODE OR CODEX DRIVE



Claude Code, Codex and other MCP agents can do everything in this manual for you: write prompts, hunt and finish shots, make pictures, songs and voices, build films and cut edits.

HOW TO CONNECT YOUR AGENT



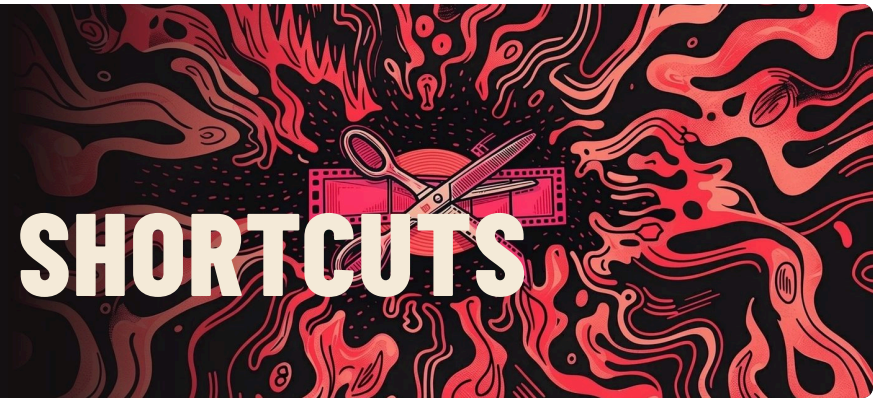
1. Open **Settings → Agents (MCP)**. This message tells your agent how to add IV Studio.
2. **Copy message**, then paste it into your agent. Or, below it, pick **Claude Code**, **Codex** or **Other (JSON)** and **Copy command**. For Claude Code, also press **Add the skill to Claude Code**.

- Restart your agent. Open a chat without a request and it offers a menu: a shot, a picture, a short film, a line, music, an edit, a website film, a swap, a new character, or a tour.
- Ask in plain words: "Make a 10 second shot of Tess in a diner, three takes, then finish the best at 1 MP."
- Its renders appear in the Queue, Shots and the Library like yours. Anything that costs money asks it to confirm first.

APPENDIX A

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

EDITOR AND APP KEYS



KEYS	IN THE EDITOR
`Space`	Play or pause
`J` `K` `L`	Shuttle backwards, stop, forwards (press again to go faster)
`I` `O`	Set In and Out marks in the source monitor
`,` `.`	Insert or overwrite the marked source on the target track
`V` `C` `B` `N`	Select, razor, ripple and roll tools
`S`	Split the selected clip at the playhead
`Ctrl` + `K`	Split every track at the playhead
`Q` `W`	Ripple-trim the clip's start or end to the playhead
`←` `→`	Step one frame (with `Shift`, one second)
`↑` `↓`	Jump to the previous or next edit point
`Home` `End`	Go to the start or end
`M`	Add a marker (`Shift` + `M` next marker, `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `M` previous)
`=` `-` `\`	Zoom in, zoom out, fit the whole edit
`Delete`	Delete the selected clip (`Shift` + `Delete` closes the gap)
`Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Y`	Undo and redo (also `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z`)
`F11` or `` ` `` · `Esc`	Full screen, and back

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> The play, shuttle, mark and step keys drive whichever monitor you clicked last: click the source monitor to use them there, the program monitor or timeline for the edit. Keys do nothing while you're typing in a field.

KEYS	ELSEWHERE
@	In a prompt: bring in a character or a place
← → ↑ ↓	In the Library viewer: versions and tiles
Esc	Close a viewer, a pop-up or a picker

APPENDIX B

TROUBLESHOOTING

WHEN SOMETHING DOESN'T WORK

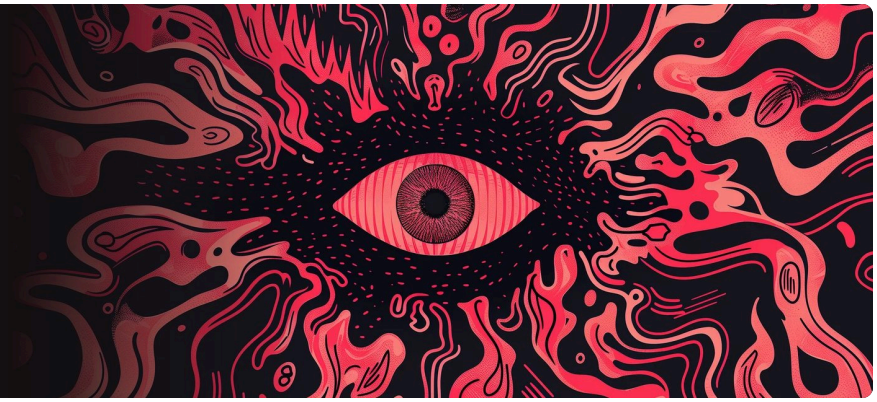


WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"ComfyUI isn't ready yet" or a red **to fix** dot	Start ComfyUI, then open Settings → Setup and press **Check again**. Check the address under Settings → ComfyUI.
A model or node pack is missing	Settings → Setup lists it with **Download** or a link. Restart ComfyUI after installing node packs.
The first render after switching tools is slow	Normal. IV Studio unloads one family of models (H3, pictures, music, voices) before loading another, so the GPU never runs out of memory.
Renders are very slow or the PC runs out of memory	Use a smaller preview size, fewer previews or Draft quality. Close other GPU apps. Check the GPU and RAM bars in the title bar.
Finishing re-renders the preview first	ComfyUI drops older results from its cache when memory is low. Finish soon after hunting, and finish one pick at a time.
The words in a shot drift from the line	Finish with Sound → **My recording**, which keeps your voice line exactly.
A character looks a little different between shots	Use the character's LoRA (Characters page), or References mode with their face picture, and keep the same strength.
The hunt won't start	The checker found an error. Use **Fix**, or **Render anyway**.
Civitai downloads fail	Add your Civitai API key in Settings → Civitai.
Voices or Lines won't speak	Press **Set up voices** once on Audio → Voices.
The cloud GPU keeps running	Cloud → **Shut down GPU**. It also shuts down on its own after the idle time you chose.
The PC crashes during long renders	That's below IV Studio: check Windows' crash records, your graphics driver and your BIOS. Long renders keep the GPU and CPU at full load, which exposes unstable hardware.

APPENDIX C

GLOSSARY

THE WORDS THIS MANUAL USES



WORD	MEANING
H3	MiniMax H3, the video model that makes shots with sound.
ComfyUI	The program on your PC that runs the models. IV Studio drives it for you.
Take / preview	One quick, small render of a shot on one seed.
Hunt	Rendering a few takes to choose from.
Finish	Rendering your chosen take again at full size and quality.
Seed	The number a render starts from. The same seed and settings give the same take.
MP	Megapixels: the size of a frame. 1 MP is about 1376 × 768 at 16:9.
Frame grid	H3 renders in fixed frame counts, so lengths round up (5 s becomes 5.17 s).
LoRA	A small add-on file that teaches a model a look, a style, a move or a person.
Character	A trained person LoRA plus its trigger word, face and voice.
RefMod	A saved reference (a look, a voice, a place or a style) applied during a render.
Reference	A picture, video or sound you give a shot to show what should appear.
Staging	Where people stand and face, and how the camera sits and moves.
Previs	A grey moving 3D guide of the staging, used as a video reference.
Animatic	The storyboard sketches played as a film with the lines.
DLSS 5 / SeedVR2	The two enhancers: quick clean-up and upscale, or slower detail restoration.
LUFS	A measure of loudness. Phones and the web expect about -14; TV -23.
MCP	The way AI agents connect to tools. IV Studio's MCP server lets agents use it.
Modal	The cloud GPU service IV Studio's Cloud mode uses, on your own account.

IV Studio is free and open source (MIT) at github.com/hollisorg/iv-studio. Model and tool credits and licences are listed in the app and its README. Made by Infinite Variance · infinitevariance.ai